Kajango by Muzee of Kanazi

Translated and Edited by P.S.

The heroic ballad of Kajango is a story about love. But its plot intersects love's trajectory after eight or ten years of marriage, when the issue of property has emerged, like a child, to become part of the relationship. The bard Muzee elaborates this issue with his characteristically tight thematic coherence, in ways that are by turns humorous, heroic, mysterious, and grotesque, but always humanely focused on the domestic pair. Property, obligation, and debt are the underlying thematic stratum in this natural and supernatural narrative of domestic love, from its opening burst of poetic images, to its parry-and-thrust of domestic bickering, to its heroic journeys, to its final reconciliation in forbearance and self-restraint.

At a symbolic level, the figure of eating — and especially of not eating — is used to talk about relationships both of love and of material exchange, as in the heroine's lament:

> Rather than eat of love, Eat something bitter from a spirit; You promise [the spirit], and in a growing-season settle the debt. But the debt of wondrous has never been settled by human kind. (lines 293–295.1)

The variety of experience this suggests — things that are bitter and those that are sweet, obligations that can be settled and those that cannot, reciprocity with spirits and its impossibility between lovers — informs and deepens the significance of Kajango's action.

This version of Kajango was recorded in the evening on August 21, 1969, in the grass-thatched house (msonge) belonging to Dionies Lutabanzibwa in the village of Katome. There were two or three dozen people present, some of whom sat outside and listened through the wall.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 1-13.2:
The ballad is introduced with a series of images that prefigure themes in the narrative to come\: action at a distance, the bickering of women, and the multifarious connections between people and things (lines 1-4.5). His wife's sharp rebuke for not being a sufficient provider motivates husband Kajango to go on a journey of trade.

NOTES

2 Although the second line, Ahi baba, baba, baba, baba, has the meaning indicated, it seems to function as a string of vocables that fix the audience's attention.

3 This ten-line string of images (lines 3-5.5) announce the principal themes of the ballad.The Spotted-one is a leopard and killing one in the kingdom of Bugabo brought iron weapons from Itahwa (Itawa), an early iron-working site in Kymutwara kingdom (Schmidt 1978, 280). The poet praises himself with the image, measuring the power of his rhetoric by the dangerousness of the leopard. That the leopard's death transcended boundaries foreshadows events in the ballad, in which the events span kingdoms and planes of reality.

4 The bickering of women that quickly overturned their reign seems to refer to a legend or proverb, but I have not found one. The quick back-and-forth of this kind of verbal interaction appears immediately. Without pausing for breath, Kajango answers his wife's complaint (line 11.1).

5 Three images for emotions associated with material goods: They sigh covetously: Nyabeteka mountain is so hard a climb that women must jettison goods they cannot carry up. Lacking space for guests combines satisfaction at the size of attendance with worry about not having enough food and drink . The coffee packet is becomes imbued with the presence of a lover.

Aya-ya, my friend,
He said, "My friend, my friend, my friend, my friend–"

A Spotted-one died in Bugabo–
He brought iron from Itahwa."

Hear the bickering of women
That quickly overturned their reign.

5 *They sigh covetously at what they cannot carry*
On Nyabeteka mountain of Luhanga.

May you lack the space to seat your guests.

The packet by a lover wrapped–
Its coffee berries you eat;
Its wrapper you sit and gaze upon."

While I was there . . .
My wife was carrying water to the house–
I had already retired.
When she came to speak to me, that wife of mine–
After she brought the water–

ILLUSTRATIONS



5.3 Banana-bast bundles: small triangular kashankala, large cylindrical olushankala.

Aya-ya baba
Ahi, "Baba baba baba baba

Kabamba yafa Bugabo -
Yashomba ebyoma Itahwa."

Hulila ewengawenge y' abakazi
Eyabaakil' engoma bwangu.

5 *Basinda ebwobatatwaala*
Nyabeteka eibanga lya Luhanga.

Kabul' emikalize.

Katwa akokomeilwe omugenda -
Kamwani okalya;
Kashankala oikala nolebaleba.

Kanabaile ndimu...
Omukazi naluga omu maizi
Nyaimile.
Kayamazile kwija kungambila, mukazi wange,
Kayalugile omu maizi,

POETIC STANZAS

3-5.1: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 2, of couplets composed as praise subject/ modifier of subject, formed in **aab** by contrast between couplets whose lines all contain both nouns and verbs (**a**'s: 3-3.1, 4-4.1) and a single couplet whose lines contain, respectively all verbs and no verb (**b**: 5-5.1).

5.3-5.5: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines composed as direct object + single verb phrase (**a**'s: 5.3, 5.4) and a line composed as direct object + double verb phrase (**b**: 5.5).

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 14-40:
He travels a route marked by named landmarks and villages.

NOTES

10 The beer jug named Half-full is used to brew beer in small quantities for household consumption. Its name suggests its frequent use. The jug at least provides something useful -- the wife asserts -- unlike her husband Kajango.

10.1 Doves are a useful symbol for marriage because they often appear in pairs walking along on the ground. As Hayas can figuratively see them, the female goes ahead as if leaving for her parents' home after a marital dispute, while the male follows after her cooing apologies and excuses. The dove at least provides some satisfaction to its mate, Kajango's wife suggests.

13.2 Beer: Kajango's request is the first appearance of a thematic sequence that begins at home and extends into the world of spirits.

14 The figure of a woman carrying her husband rather than her child on her back is sometimes used to describe strange places; see The Tree Mwata:107.

ILLUSTRATIONS



10 Ekimuga

POETIC STANZAS

9-13: compound stanza, 2 + 8 + 2, formed by contrast between lines composed as locutive + "my husband"/ verb phrase (**a**'s: 9-9.1, 13-14) and intervening lines (**b**'s: 10-11.3); the latter comprise two stanzas in **aabb** (10-10.3, 11-11.3); the first of these is formed by contrast between two lines composed as "You're worth less than" + noun + modifier (**a**'s :10-10.1) and two lines that cohere by similarly inflected verbs in initial position; the first line (11) of the second such stanza (11-11.3) both finalizes the previous two lines (10.2, 10.3), inscribing them in a pattern of **aab**, and initiates the new stanzaic pattern of **aabb** formed by contrast between two lines that cohere by repetition of "they'd carried so much they were throwing things down" (**a**'s: 11-11.1) and lines that cohere by enjambment (**b**'s: 11.2, 11.3); note how Kajango's immediate appropriation of his wife's words (line 11) into the stanzaic pattern formed by his own utterance makes her less sure of herself: she pauses after "my husband" (13-14) as she did not do before (9-9.1).

13.1-14.3: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between two couplets whose lines cohere solely by enjambment (**a**'s: 13.1-13.2, 14-14.1) and one couplet whose lines cohere by a number sequence.

She said, "My husband,
You never go to trade.

You're worth less than the beer jug at your father's place,*Half-Full*.
You're worth less than the dove, the *Trilling-voice*.
I'd gone for water when
I saw the traders–real men."

She said, "They'd carried so many things they were throwing some away."
He said, "My wife, if they'd carried so many they were throwing some away,
Why not pick up a few and bring them here
So I might see them too?"

She said, "My husband,
There's more to it than that."

When the man awoke, he cut bananas for beer.
He said, "Ferment some mash for me, if you please. I'm going to trade.
I'll go to Buha of Nyalwongo,
Where a woman grinds grain with her husband on her back.
The days I spend there will be eight.
On the ninth I'd like to find you've brewed the beer for me."

He tied a bundle full of clattering things.
The road for Ilogelo he knew well.

Ahi, "Mushaija wange,
Totunda.

Nokilwa ekimuga ky' omwa isho *Bwishegati*.

Nokilwa akaiba *Lukongota*.
Naba ngenzile omu maizi,
Nabona abashaija batunzi."

Ahi,"Batwete mbanaga."

Ahi,"Mukazi wange, olwo batwete mbanaga,

Kutaba walonda bike 'kandetela
Nkaija nkaleba?"

Ahi, "Mushaija wange,
Tinkugambile goona."

Omushaija kayaimukile, yatema enkundi.
Ati, "Onyalikile omulamba. Nagya kutunda.

Ngende Buha bwa Nyalwongo,
Mbali omukazi asa ahekile iba.

Ebilo nagya kumalayo munana.
Ekya mwenda nshange onjungile omulamba."

Yakoma lwakekela.
Omuhanda yamanya ogwa Ilogelo.

NOTES

17 The Christian name George (line 17) and the reference to ethnic East Indians (line 28) suggest that the landscape envisioned is a contemporary one.

26.1 Not a belt refers to the road travelled. It may look like a belt, stretching off into the distance, but it takes effort to travel it.

27 Pained-one and Arouser-of-desire address a female member of the audience.

POETIC STANZAS

17-17.2: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines composed as preposition + placename (**a**'s: 17, 17.1) and a line with an initial verb (**b**: 17.2).

18-18.4: stanza in **abbba** formed by contrast betweeen lines that begin with "He took" (**a**'s: 18, 18.4) and lines that begin with (or contain) "he went" (18.1, 18.2, 18.3).

19-21: stanza in **abba** formed by contrast between lines with initial verbs (**a**'s: 19, 21) and lines without initial verbs (**b**'s: 19.1, 20: no verb and direct object initial, respectively).

22-24: stanza in **aaaba** formed by contrast between lines with initial verbs (**a**'s: 22, 22.1, 22.2, 24) and a single line without an initial verb (**b**: 23).

32-35: stanza in **abba** formed by contrast between lines that begin with the verb, "he took" (**a**'s: 32, 35) and lines that have no verb (**b**'s: 33, 34).

35.1-37: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 1, formed by contrast between couplets composed as direct object (place) + verb + placename/ "he went" + placename (**a**'s: 35.1-35.2, 36-36.1) and a single line with an initial form of the verb "to be" (**b**: 37).

At the house of Bilaze of George
    He went to Kamitenga.
He took it straight.
    He went to Bigugo, to Kashalala.
    He went to Lutenge.
    He descended and went to Kyamalebe and Low-water crossing.
    He took the road for Lugongo.

When he reached Nyakisingilo,
    At Lyambo's and Lukaza-magulu's in Ihangilo,
At Ngalama he went into the town of Kishanda.
He travelled west.

He asked the way to Kibale and Kiwela.
    He went to Mikale.
    He went to Kabayondo.
Nshamba of Igabilo.
He climbed to Kabale.

    In Ihangilo the Kabales are many.
There is Kabale of Mwamali,
Fearless one of Migongo.
    It is not a belt tied about your waist.
You have seen it, Pained-one.
    Listen, Arouser-of-desire.

From Kitebelo at the Indians'
    He took the road to Kahu.
My friend

He went towards Kyeshongele.
    He was on the road
    My kings!

Ya-ya-ya-ya

He took it towards Itongo of Kajalaba.
You of Luhanga and Kyolele,
Bilabo of Ntagonga.
He took the road.

    The pass, he took to Ngote.
    He went to Mugolo.
The hill, he descended to Kilibino.
    He went to Kamishango.
That's him in Mumpanda.

Omwa Bilaza owa Ijuuje
    Yagya Kamitenga.
Yakwata gumoi.
    Yagya Bigugo, Kashalala.
    Yagya Lutenge.
    Yasooka yagya Kyamalebe na Kabulamaizi.

    Yakwata omuhanda gwa Lugongo.

Kayagobile Nyakisingilo,
    Omwa Lyambo na Lukaza-magulu Ihangilo,
Ngalama yagya omu mugini gwa Kishanda.
Yakwata omukono gw'obugwa izooba.

Yabaza ogwa Kibale na Kiwela.
    Yagya Mikale.
    Yagya Kabayondo.
Nshamba ya Igabilo.
Yatembuuka Kabale.

    Ihangilo Kabale ni nyingi.
Alimu Kabale ka Mwamaali,
Omutaitiina wa Migongo.
    Tiguba mpuuta bakugwekomile enda.
Waibona ya *Lushashwa*.
    Hulila, *Omugiza-mailu*.

Kitebelo omu Bahindi
    Yakwata omuhanda gwa Kahu.
Baba

Yakwata Kyeshongele.
    Yagya omuhanda
    Bakama bange!

Ya-ya-ya-ya

Yakwata Itongo lya Kajalaba.
Inywe aba Luhanga na Kyolele,
Bilabo bya Ntagonga.
Yakwata omuhanda.

    Empalo akakwata eya Ngote.
    Yagya Mugolo.
Eibanga yasooka Kilibino.
    Yagya Kamishango.
Niw'ogu Mumpanda.

When he had arrived
Among the thickets of Mubunda of Kitoko…
Ahi Ya ya ya ya-ah
Eye ye ye-eh
Ye ye ye-eh ye-e-eh
Ye-e-eh

It travels like a creeper vine.
May you lack the space to seat your guests.
The packet by a lover wrapped–
Its coffee berries you eat;
Its wrapper you sit and gaze upon, Lujoge."
Then the sun set.
Among the thickets of Mubunda
I met an elder woman digging yams.

I say, "Mother, give me lodging. I need a place to lie down."
"My house cannot be lain in."
"What forbids it to be lain in?"
She says, "My child has gone to trade."

"What took he when he went?"
"His spear and hafted-knife, Provider."
Among the houses where he went, of what sort does he sleep in?
She said, "I only know he went. He sleeps where men have built, Lujoge."

He said, "I also have a spear and hafted knife.
I sleep where men have built.
Don't worry about your yams–they're not the food I want to eat.
I am a trader. I have *enshankala* plantains."
The elder woman returned with me.
At home she offered lodging. I agreed.

Kayabaile yagoba
Omu nshaka za Mubunda gwa Kitoko…
Ahi Ya ya ya ya-ah
Eye ye ye-eh
Ye ye ye-eh ye-e-eh
Ye-e-eh

Lugendwa nko olutontozi olwe kibanga.
Kabul' emikalize.
Katwa akokomeilwe omugenda -
Kamwani okalya;
Kashankala oikala nolebaleba, Lujoge.
Aho eizooba lyagwa.
Omu nshaka za Mubunda.
Nashanga omukaile naiya emfuma.

Nti,"Mawe ompe eikumbi. Ningonza kunyiama."

"Omwange tenyiamwamu."
"Ekyagitangile kunyiamwamu?"
Ati,"Omwaana wange akagya kutunda."

"Akagenda akweteki?"
"Eichumu lye no omwolo, Lugaba."
"Amaju akagenda, nalala nkaha?"

Ati, "Manya akagenda. Nalala omu gombekilwe, Lujoge."

Ahi, "Nanye nyina eichumu no mwolo.
Nindala omu gombekile.
Otashasibwa emfuma. Ti 'zo ndikwenda kulya.

Naba ndi mutunzi. Nyina oluhagala lw'enshakala."
Omukaikulu yaijulula.
Yampa eikumbi nakunda.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 42-42.4:
The singer interrupts the journey by revisiting the ballad's initial poetic images, adding one about passion.

NOTES

42 Creeper vine is an image used here both for a meandering journey and for love, sensations of which sinuously cover the body, as a lutontozi vine covers the ground.

42.1 Three images for emotions associated with material goods: They sigh covetously: Nyabeteka mountain is so hard a climb that women must jettison goods they cannot carry up. Lacking space for guests combines satisfaction at the size of attendance with worry about not having enough food and drink . The coffee packet is becomes imbued with the presence of a lover.

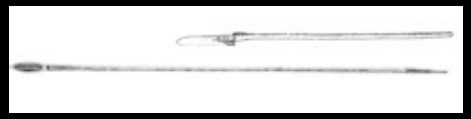
44 Mubunda is a region in the southern part of Ihangiro Kingdom.

47 Lugaba, "Provider," is a term of respect often used for a king or nobleman.

48.1 Lujoge is a recurring name that apparently refers to Kajango, but I do not know its meaning.

50.1 Enshankala plantains are evidently not the best. They were prescribed as punishment in The Place You Come From (line 256)

ILLUSTRATIONS



47 Spear (eichumu, below) and Hafted knife (omwolo, above)

POETIC STANZAS

37.1-44.1: verse passage in **aba** formed by repetition of a prepositional phrase (**a**'s: 37.1, 44) with intervening lines of vocables, praise, and temporal description (**b**'s: 38-41, 42-42.4, 43; respectively)

42.3-42.4: see note for 5.3-5.5.

44.2-45.2: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines of quoted questions (**a**'s: 44.2, 45.1) and lines of quoted answers (**b**'s: 45, 45.2).

46-48.1: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines of quoted questions (**a**'s: 46, 48) and lines of quoted answers (**b**'s: 47, 48.1)

49-51.1: compound stanza in **aba**, 2 + 2 + 2, formed by two line pairs of sentences composed as noun (or pronoun) + verb phrase/ verb initial…(**a**'s: 49-49.1, 51-51.1) contrasted with one line pair with two sentences per line (**b**'s: 50-50.1).

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 52-64:
At sunset, Kajango seeks a place to sleep, convincing an elder woman to give him lodging by indicating the similarity of his situation to that of her son who also is on a journey of trade. Kajango swears a blood brotherhood with the woman's neighbor, which creates a relationship of mutual aid.

Lines 65-93:
Continuing on his journey, Kajango comes upon a rhinoceros and bravely kills it (lines 65-83.1). Immediately beset by a band of local hunters, he proves his entitlement to the spoils of the hunt, removes the rhino's tail and horns, and sets out for home.

NOTES

52 This line is part of a set epithets that the poet uses elsewhere as well to embellish the reference to the evening hours (Kaiyula:78 and Kachwenyanja:19) but with modifications to suit the context.

54 Blood brotherhood is a form of fictive kinship between men. It is ceremonially created when each partner makes a small incision near his navel, places a drop of his blood on one half of a coffee berry, and gives it to his partner to eat. It was especially useful in establishing relationships of trust among trading partners.

62 The sun rises from the waters of Lake Victoria to the east.

66 The poet elaborates this moment of discovery with conjectures about the animals that might be present along with their respective praise epithets. The bard Abdallah Feza employs the same technique at a crucial moment in Kitekere (lines 219-241).

POETIC STANZAS

52-53.1: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between two couplets of adverbial phrases (**a**'s: 52-52.1, 52.2-52.3) and a single couplet of verb initial independent phrases.

When evil roams,
When a person faints and does not revive . . .
As I was there,
The sun was in its evening hour,
I met their neighbor.
We spoke of many things.

He said, "Let's make the cut, sir. Let's swear blood brotherhood this day!"
He said, "And when night gives way to the early light of dawn,
And you resume your trading trip,
Let me guide you through the wilderness.
There,
In the land of wild animals,
Let me guide you to Kakili,
One Kakili village then the other."
When night gave way to the early light of dawn,
My blood brother came promptly.
He guided me to Kakili.
We passed the other Kakili too.

The sun emerged from the water.
And when the sun had emerged from the water,
He said, "My blood brother, now you can't get lost."

After I had passed the one Kakili then the other,
I heard a cracking sound before me in the brush.

I looked. There was no buffalo in there,
Great curved horn, the Hanging-noose.
There was no lion, the *Roan-beast*.
No elephant, the *Elder of the wilderness*.
When I looked I found a rhino, *Shrill-cry*,
Its eye I likened to a small hole in a dark ceiling.

62-64: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that are repetitions and transformations of each othe (**a**'s: 62, 63) and a single line of quoted speech (**b**: 64).

Mbali ekibi kigendela,
Mbali omuntu akabila atahimbuke,
Kanabaile ndiho,
Eizooba lya bwaigolo.
Mbuganganwa mwatani wabo.
Twagamba goona.

Ahi, "Iwe mushaija, twagushala, twagunywana kilo ekyo!"

Ahi, "K'obwile bulasinga bukyakya,

Nogenda gwa kutunda.
Nyije nkuteze eilungu,
Kununju,
Nsi y'ebikaka.
Nkuteze Kakili,
Kakili aka na aka."
Olw' obwile bwasingile bukyakya,
Munywanyi wange yaija nailuka.
Yanteeza Kakili.
Twahingula Kakili aka.

Eizooba lyashabuka omu maizi.
Olwo eizooba lyashabukile omu maizi,
Ati, "Munywanyi wange tokihungela."

Kanabaile nahingula Kakili aka na aka
Mpulila omu maisho ekyamogola.

Naleba. Telabamu embogo,
Kihembe nyakatanzi.
Telaba ntale, *Lwagaju*.
Ti njoju, *Mukulu we'ilungu*.
Mbali nkalebeile nshanga nkula, *Lwakifooto*.
Akaisho kayo nkalenga akahengezi k'enju.

66-69: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2, formed by couplets composed as negative verb + animal name [/+] praisename (**a**'s:66-67, 68-68.1; the former completes the formula once in two lines, the latter twice) contrasted with a couplet with similar composition but positive verbs (**b**: 69-69.1).

NOTES

73.3 In traditional belief, termite mounds may envelop the spirits of deceased nobles. Here the mound saves the endangered hunter as a mother would comfort a child - by hoisting him on her back and covering him with a carrying cloth.

POETIC STANZAS

70-73: compound stanza 3 + 3 + 1, formed in **aab** by contrast between units composed of vocables and couplets (**a**'s: 70-71.1, 72-73), in which lines of couplets cohere internally by composition as verb + weapon + "and" + weapon and as " I let fly"... respectively, contrasted with a single line composed as a double verb formation (**b**: 73.1).

78-80: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines composed as "I see..." + verb phrase (**a**'s: 78, 79.1) and lines composed as "I go and I" + verb phrase (**b**'s: 79, 80).

80.1-81.1: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines composed as verb initial + body part (**a**'s: 80.1-81) and a verb initial line composed differently.

82-83.1: stanza in x**aab** formed by contrast between lines composed as "I killed" + praisename (**a**'s: 82.1, 83) and one line comprised solely of praisenames (**b**: 83.1).

Ya-a-a
I dropped the hafted knife and spear.
I kept the bow and quiver.
Ya-a-a
May one fly from me, find its way, and bite.
I let an arrow fly.
It found its way. It caught him.
He approached and spied me.
I hid behind a termite mound
And found that mound just right for me.
A hole opened and wrapped me in its cover.

He obliged: he turned away, *Shrill-cry*,
Calves with heavy foot-falls,
His eye, a small hole in a dark ceiling,
Come, you are aided by ngege.
Yo-o-o
He knelt before me.

As I studied him,
I thought, "He's studying me, the rhino."
But then I see his belly slacken.
I toss a clod of earth on him.
I see he does not stir.
I arise from the hole.
I cut the tail.
And then I mount his belly.
I whoop and ululate.

"You men of Ihangilo,
I've killed the *Calf-that-does-not-hinder*.
I've killed *Lwangege*,
His eye, a small hole in a dark ceiling."
I heard the men of Ihangilo with their hunting dogs and iron bells.
They blew their horns.

They said, "Leave off!
A lousy Kymutwaalan come and kill the grey-one?
The grey-one's beaten a native son–
Was it killed by a lousy Kyamtwaalan?"

Ya-a-a
Mpulila nanaga omuholo n'eichumu lyange.
Nasigala n'obuta n'ekilimba.
Ya-a-a
Kanjugunye gugye gunene.
Najugunya omuhambi.
Gwagya gwagikwata.
Yaija emboine.
Kweshumba aha kishwa
Mbona ekishwa kyandonda.
. Ekina kyashala engozi kyanziika.

Yankunda yanguluka *Lwakifooto*,
Mfundo z'ebilindigita,
Akaisho kayo kahengezi k'enju,
Oija ojunilwa ngege.
Yo-o-o
Yamfukama omu maisho.

Mbali nkagilebeile
Nti, "Ndebile kunteela nkula."
Mbona ekibunda kyahuka.
Ngya njugunya eikoote.
Mbona tetengya.
Ngya nduga omu kina ekyo.
Ngishala ekyoshe.
Nshuba ngitungamila olubunda.
Ntamu akalulu.

"Inywe Banyaihangilo,
Nagiita *Mfundo-etamulema*.
Nagiita *Lwangege*,
Akaisho kayo kahengezi k'enju."
Nkahulila Banyaihangilo n'embwa zabo n'ebyoma.

Bateela oluzamba.

Bati, "Leka iwe!
Akazilo k' omutwaala kugya kwiita enkula?
Enkula yalema omutuzi.
Yaitwa kazilo k' omutwaala?"

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 93.1-110.2:
Joyously announcing his presence along the way, he is greeted by his wife in the forecourt of their house (lines 93.1-97.1). But she does not know the value of rhinoceros horns, and she sharply berates him again, this time for bringing worthless things.

NOTES

89 This is one of three kings of Ihangiro who are named Nyarubamba. There is an epic ballad by that name.

90 Fire-forbidden refers to the leopard, which is said to be afraid of fire.

90 The images in these two lines refer to the chicken, to whom King Nyarubamba may be related via totemic association.

POETIC STANZAS

87-88.1: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines composed as double verb formations that include "cut open" (**a**'s: 87, 88) and lines that refer to an arrow inside the animal (**b**'s: 87.1, 88.1)

91-93: stanza in **abac** formed by contrast between lines that begin with a 1st person aside in the distant past tense (**a**'s:91, 92) and others not so composed (**a**: 91.1, **c**:93).

93.1-94.1: stanza in **aba** formed by contrast between lines that contain "slept away" (**a**'s: 93.1, 94.1) and a line marked by Ø verb.

95-97.1: stanza in **axa**aa**b** formed by contrast between lines that begin with a double word formation (**a**'s: 95, 96, 96.1, 97) and a line that begins with a single verb with a similar inflection (**b**:97.1); an aside is interpolated as the second line (**x**: 95.1).

98-103.4: mirror stanzas (98-102.1, 102.2-103.4) of three couplets each; 98-99 - cohere by marked use of distant past tense (also used in the final line of the figure, 103.4); 100 is an interpolated aside; 100.1-102 - cohere semantically as sentences about laughter; 102.2-103 - cohere semantically as sentences about trading items; 103.1-103.2 cohere semantically as stimulus and response; final couplets in both stanzas (102-102.1, 103.3-103.4) are composed as adverbial past perfect verb + ..."leaving the hearth space" / modified double verb formation (verbs in different tenses).

I say, "Don't be ashamed.
Go ahead and cut it open.
You'll find my arrow in there."
They agreed. They cut it open.
They took out an *engona* arrow.

They said, "Don't be ashamed, you men of Nyalubamba,
Missile that strikes the place of danger,
He that enters 'Warrior's-Death' with laughter on his lips,
Fire-forbidden, Iron-one,
From the home of Missile-strikes-a-bull's-back,
Keeps watch 'til dawn, Dried leaves, Iron hammer,
Tail-cutter and Non-knower."

I heard them say, "Don't be ashamed, child.
Let the man of Kyamutwaala take the rhino."
They let me take the front horn and the back.
I put them with the tail I'd cut.

I'd slept one night away from home.
What happiness that day, my kings!
I did not sleep away again.

I go and stand on a hill,
As I might stand at Lyamaholo Bugengele.
As I travel along, I whoop and ululate.
I go and yell it loud.
I add the sound of my buffalo horn,
I'm just like a trader.

My wife heard the buffalo horn.
She met me in the forecourt of the house.
–You know how women always peek inside.–
She came laughing the laughter of weaverbirds,
Her molars showing on both sides.
She welcomed me, coming from the hearth.
Then she went and peeked inside.

She found the rhino horns I'd wrapped in bast.
The tail was also there.
She searched, but nothing was there to eat: no piece of meat, no fish.
She said, "You, husband!"
She'd been laughing in the forecourt, the whole way from the hearth.
But approaching then, she did not laugh.

Nti, "Mutagooka.
Mubanze mugibage.
Mulebemu omuhambi gwange."
Enkula bakunda bagibaga.
Baiyamu gw'engona.

Bahi, "Mutagooka bashaija ba Nyalubamba,
Kalasho nyamulasha ahabi.
Nyamutaha Kiita-manzi ikakenkemuka,
Kizila-mulilo kya koma,
Omwa Kalasho kalasha engundu aha mugongo,
Kanyamukeisa lushankala lw' akanyondo,
Gatem' enkila na Tamanyiile."

Nkahulila: "Bojo, mutagooka.
Enkula kagitwaale y' Omutwaala."
Nkabona: Nagihyaho eihembe elya bulyo n'elya bumosho.
Nagita aha kyoshe kyange.

Omwaitu nkaba nshuzile kimoi.
Amashemelelwa kilo ekyo, bakama bange,
Tinashuzile.

Ngya nyema aha akabanga,
Nk' okwo nakuba ninyema Lyamaholo Bugengele.
Ngenda ntamu akalulu.
Ngya nkelekeza
Nshuba nteela eilenge.
Nshana omutunzi.

Omukazi akahulila eilenge.
Akambuganganwa omu kibuga.
Abakazi batuula mbatiga.
Yaija nanshekela ensheko z' ebitanda.
Eigigo nayoleka eli n' eli.
Kayamtwile, kagile kuluga enjulugulu
Yaija yatigile.

Abona amahembe g' enkula nigo nkomile omu byahi.
Aliho ekyoshe kyayo.
Yaleba talimu ka kulya: ti kanyama ti nfulu.

Ati, "Iwe mushaija!"
Kayabaile nanshekela omu kibuga, kuluga enjulugulu,

Akaija atakisheka.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 110.3-146:
Kajango angrily sets out again and travels north toward Ankole (lines 110.3-140). He crosses the Kagera River and asks directions (lines 141-146). He meets royal herders who, seeing what he has brought in trade, convey Kajango to the king.

NOTES

107.2 You kill me - with laughter, that is. More sarcastic bickering. But from what she is about to say, the wife clearly does not understand the value of the hard-won trophies.

112.4 Buzinja, home of the Bazinja or Bazinza people, is the kingdom to the south of Hayaland. Mubunda, where Kajango spent the night before killing the rhinoceros is not far away from there.

POETIC STANZAS

111-116: mirror stanzas (111-112.2, 112.3-113.1, 114-116) of four lines each, composed as [initial] verb + placename/ initial verb + placename/ Aside/ initial verb + place description

117-118: stanza in **abba** formed by contrast between lines with Ø verb (**a**'s: 117, 118) and lines with an initial verb (**b**'s: 17.1, 17.2)

"What is it, mother?
What is it, Honored one?
What is it, *Heart of our people*,
Arms that roll me,
Hands caress me:
Things you give to me."

He said, "What did I do?"
"My husband,
You don't just make me laugh–you KILL me.
Cattle horns you left in Kianja!
Did you trade for them in Buzinja?"
I felt anger seize me.

Then she pressed banana mash,
But I refused it.
I said, "I'm tired. I've come from trading."
Of the plantains I ate half a piece.
When night had almost given way to the early light of dawn,
I took my things and went to trade.

The low road I descended to Mafumbo.
I looked toward Bujumba.
The lake's not wide there.
I crossed the water.
I travelled to Bumbile Island.
I travelled to trade the goods of Buzinja.

Let's go.
I descend toward the west.
I descended to Makongola by the low road at Kijunjula's.
I took the road past Lwailundu.
Kitinde stream sparkles and bobs.
I took the pass between the mountains.
In Kazila-mfuka at Lutizibwa's in the forecourt
I took the road to Luhija.
I came to Kamilondo mountain.
All you of Nyakijuganwa

Aha-a-a
Ye-e-e
Ye-e-e
Ye-ye-ye Ye-ye-ye

"Wabaki mawe?
Wabaki Nyakubaho?
Wabaki *Mwooyo gw'abaitu boona?*
Bikono bintilimbila,
Mikono emigamiga,
Eby'okumpa iwe."

Ati, "Ekyonakola ni kiha?"
"Na iwe mushaija wange,
Toshekyaa, oita.
Amahembe g'ente wagasiga Kianja!
Wagya kugatunda Buzinja?"
Nkahulila enabi yankwata.

Kayajungiile omulamba,
Nkagwanga.
Nti, "Nyina amalemwa. Ndugile kutunda."
Ekitoke nalyaho ebege emoi.
K'obwile bwasingile bukyakya,

Nabilonda nagya kutunda.

Empalo nkakongokela Mafumbo.
Naleba Bujumba.
Taliyo nyanja mpango.
Nakushuba omu maizi.
Nagenda Bumbile.
Nagenda kutunda ebya Buzinja.

Oleke.
Nkongokela omukono gw'obugwa izooba.
Nkakongokela Makongola empalo y'omwa Kijunjuula.
Nakwata Lwailundu.
Kitinde neyaka bwanzinginya.
Nakwata olutanda.
Kazila-mfuka omwa Lutizibwa omu ilembo
Nakwata omuhanda gwa Luhija.
Naija Kamilondo.
Inywe Abanyakijuganwa

Aha-a-a
Ye-e-e
Ye-e-e
Ye-ye-ye Ye-ye-ye

NOTES

126 Manueli's bar is near the place of the bard's performance.

135.1 The image of the spotted-one, leopard, refers to and praises the poet.

143 The house columns have no storage at the top because they are so high.

144 Ankole is a region in western Uganda renown for its abundance of cattle.

POETIC STANZAS

123-126: stanza in **abba** formed by contrast between lines that contain the verb "drink" (**a**'s: 123, 126) and those that do not (**b**'s: 124, 125)

127-130.1: stanza in **aa**aa**bb** formed by contrast between lines composed as Ø verb [...] + placename (**a**'s: 127, 128, 129.1, 129.2) and lines composed as initial verb + "(road)" (**b**'s: 130, 131)

131-132.2: stanza in **aabb** formed by contrast between lines composed as placename/description + verb + placename (**a**'s: 131, 132) with lines composed as initial verb + "road" + "of" + placname.

137-137.3: stanza in **aabb** formed by contrast between lines composed as initial verb "arrive" + placename (**a**'s:137, 137.2) and lines composed as initial verb "go" + placename (**b**'s:132.1, 132.3).

138-140: stanza in **abxab** formed by contrast between lines composed as adverbial past perfect verb initial + placename/description (**a**'s: 138, 139.2) and lines composed as narrative present initial verb + placename (**b**'s: 139, 140).

I'll drink it at Kafunjo or at Kitala of Mpa.
Wewe
Straight, straight, straight ahead, I shuffled.
There in Nyakibimbili I drank it at Manueli's.

You men of Katome,
Of Kagabilo in Bajuga,
Ha-a-a
  In Mbale at Kyabuganzi's
  And Lutiluuti's in the forecourt
I knew the road to Kagabilo
  I took the one to Luhunga and Kashaalu.

At the wide ferry I ferried across at Kansinda.
From Kaigembi I travelled to Ishozi of Nshalaazi.
  I took the road to Nkenge.
  I saw the road to Bugolola.

Weye-e
Ho-o-o
She went to sleep after abusing me.
  I bring these matters, The Spotted-one.

At Kyaka,
I'd not yet reached the ferry on the Kagera when
  I reached Lunywebwa.
  I went to Kenkondo.
  I went to Malenge.
When I reached Kituku in the forecourt,
I asked for Kyembunda of Muguta,
  Muguta of Kabundama, the founder.
  When I came to Kisimani,
I stopped at Kabumbilo's in Kisimani.
  I hailed across the river in Kitala of Menge,
"You men of Kitala of Menge,
  Paddle me across. I'll pay"
They agreed.
  Mpeta Malobo took me in his canoe.
  I crossed to the other shore.

  When I reached the palace of Nyamutula,
Columns in Kakoko's house have no storage,
"Please show me the road for Ankole."
They say, "Go west."
I shuffled along.

Kanganywe Kafunjo angili Kitala kya Mpa.
Wewe
Gumoi gumoi gumoi nasoleza
Kununju Nyakibimbili naganywa omwa Manoli.

Inywe bashaija ba Katome,
Kagabilo ka Bajuga
Ha-a-a
  Mbale omwa Kyabuganzi
  Na Lutiluuti omu ilembo
Namanya omuhanda gwa Kagabilo
  Nakwata ogwa Luhunga na Kashaalu.

Ekishabukilo ekihango nkashabukila Kansinda.
Kaigembi nakwata Ishozi lye Nshalaazi.
  Nakwata omuhanda gwa Nkenge.
  Naleba omuhanda gwa Bugolola.

Weye-e
Ho-o-o
Alaile anjumile.
  Nimbileta Kabamba

Kyaka,
Ntagobilemu obushabukilo Kagela,
  Nagobela Lunywebwa.
  Nagya Kenkondo.
  Nagya Malenge.
Kanagobile omwa Kituku omu ilembo,
Ndaga Kyembunda kya Muguta,
  Muguta gwa Kabundama.
  Kanaizile Kisimani,
Nkema omwa Kabumbilo Kisimani.
  Nakaguza ababuseli Kitala kya Menge.
"Inywe bashaija ba Kitala Kya Menge,
  Mumbuge, mpoole"
Bakunda.
  Mpeta Malobo yanta omu bwaato.
  Nashabuka buseli.

  Kanagobile omwa Nyamutula,
Kakooko nyomyo eitaina ikani,
"Mundage omuhanda gugya Nkole."
Bati, "Okwate omukono gwo'bugwa izooba."
Nasoleza.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 152-163:
The king trades more than a hundred cattle and a herd of goats for the rhino horns and tail, and Kajango brings them home (lines 152-157.1). He enters triumphantly, announcing his presence with hunting horn and self-praise poetry.

NOTES

158 Bugengele and Lyamaholo are villages near the place of performance.

159.3 A mouth can show cheer in adversity by smiling.

159.4 Creeper vine is an image used here both for a meandering journey and for love, sensations of which sinuously cover the body, as a lutontozi vine covers the ground.

160 Falls on its back, a leather kilt works is an image that I have tried to interpret but cannot.

160.2 Floating plants, bwonge, are images of travel, I believe.

160.3 The Great-calfed one here refers to the fisher god Mugasha.

161.1 This is part of Kajango's self-praise (ebyebugo). It proclaims his virtue of self-knowledge: The person who knows himself does not eat as a child, that is, does not eat indiscriminately.

POETIC STANZAS

148-151.1: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 3 + 2, formed by contrast between linegroups that combine two interlocutor's quoted utterances (**a**'s: 148-148.1, 149-149.1) and a linegroup that comprises the words of a single speaker (**b**:151-151.1).

152-155: Stanza in **aab**, formed by contrast between lines whose main verbs are in the near past tense (152, 153,153 and a line whose main verb is in the distant past (**b**'s: 155).

When I came to Ankole,
I found men pasturing cattle.
These were the first I met.

"You, man, what seek you in trade?"
I say, "I seek bulls and cows."
"What have you brought?"
I say, "I have the tail of a rhino, *Shrill-cry*.
I have both the rhino's horns."
"Enough. We'll take you to our king.
He's in the kraal."

When they had brought me to the kraal, I showed the rhino's things.
The front horn he traded for sixty cattle.
And the back one brought fifty.
The tail I traded for a herd of goats.

"Let me return now, Good One."
I turned toward home and started out with my cattle.
I crossed over.

When I approached our village–
There was a hill: as at Bugengele you can hear all the way to Lyamaholo–
I blew my horn just like a trader.

Whoever stands there asks,
"Has he come, Lujoge?
Has he come, the *Revealer of glad tidings*?
Has he come, *Shows-cheer-in-adversity like the mouth*?"

It travels like a creeper vine.
May you lack the space to seat your guests.
The packet by a lover wrapped–
Its coffee berries you eat;
It falls on its back
A leather kilt works
Floating plants of the Kagera River
Waves of Lake Victoria of the Great-calfed one.
My friend,
He-who-knows-himself eats not the food of children in a small basket.

Kanabaile nagya Nkole,
Nashanga abashaija bemeile ente.
Nibo nabandize kubagobela.

"Iwe mushaija notundaki?"
Inye nti, "Nintunda enumi n'ente."
"Eky'olesile ni kihai?"
Nti, "Nyina ekyoshe ky'enkula, Lwakifooto.
Nyina amahembe g'enkula gombili."
"Oleke. Tukutwaale mukama waitu.
Ali omu kilalo."

Kabangobize ekilalo, namwoleka ely'enkula.

Eihembe lya bulyo yaligula nkaga ente.
Kandi elya bumosho lyateela agatanu.
Ekyoshe nkakigula embuzi olumeme.

"Muleke ngalukile aho Mulungi."
Nakunda nakubuka n'ente zange.
Nashabuka.

Kanabaile nagoba omwaitu,
Akaba aliho akabanga okw' ohulila aka Bugengele kwema Lyamaholo,
Nateela eilenge nk' omutunzi.

Ayayemile oku
Ahi, "Yakwija, *Lujoge*.
Yakwija *Luchulula lwa nkulu nungi*.
Yakwija *Myemalamalo nk' omunwa*."

Gugenda nk'olutontozi lw'ekibanga.
. Kabulwe mikalize.
Katwa kakomeilwe omugenda,
Kamwani okalya.
Lugwa bugaze
Enkanda ikolela
Bwonge bwa Kagela
Iyengo lya Lwelu lya Bwamfundo.
Baba
Nyamyemanyo lutalya by' abato omu kiibo.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 164-172.1:
Kajango's wife hurries to receive him. She squeezes some banana mash for him and cooks him a meal, but he refuses, declaring his fatigue.

Lines 173-190:
She makes elaborate herbal preparations for their lovemaking but finds Kajango already asleep (lines 173-81.1). She pleads with and praises him, but he does not wish to be disturbed.

POETIC STANZAS

167-172.1: three mirror stanzas (**167-169.1**, **170-170.3**, **171-172.1**) formed semantically by compositional units of wife's action (167-167.2, 170, 171), husband's response (168.1, 170.1, 171.1), and an articulated reason for his response (169, 170.2-.3, 172-172.1); first and second stanzas begin with "on that day"; second and third stanzas share reasons.

174-176.1: stanza in **aabbbbbb** formed by contrast between lines with an initial verb (**a**'s:174, 175) and lines with Ø verb composed of plant names (**b**'s: 175.1- 176.1).

Ha-a-a
Ha-a-a

I had great strength.
I saw my wife come running.
I met her in the forecourt.

When she saw the cattle on this side and that,
And goats pouring all over our farm,
She did not look at me at all.

That day she jumped and ran to the hearth.
She tore off ripe bananas.
She squeezed sweet mash for me.
Yo-o-o
I did not drink it.
You don't love me.
You love the things.

That day she squeezed sweet mash.
I refused it, Lujoge.
I said, "I still feel tired, mother.
I've come from trading."

She cooked some food.
I broke off half a plantain.
I said, "I feel tired.
I've come from trading."

Soon it was evening just as now.
She went out on the pathway to the farm.
She brought back herbs: Sweetness-of-*lushakala*,
Kashunshu-leaves-that-fall-themselves,
Nurses-get-ready,
Soul-flees-them,
Heart-stealer.
She did herself for me with Stray's-Return.
May-nettle-sting-all-over.
Return-to-where-it-stubs-the-toe,
Eshube kishanja.

Ha-a-a
Ha-a-a

Nakwata gangi.
Mpulila omukazi wange akaija nailuka.
Nkamushagamu omu kibuga.

Kayaboine ente lubaju olu n'olu,
Embuzi zasheshekila ekibanga,
Tiyalebile inye nangu.

Kilo ekyo akailuka ataile enjulugulu.
Yanyukula ebiise.
Yanjungila omulamba.
Yo-o-o
Tinagunyoile.
Toyendanye
Oyenda ebintu.

Omu kilo ekyo yajunga omulamba.
Nagwanga, Lujoge.
Nti, "Nkyaina amalemwa mawe.
Ndugile kutunda."

Yabichumba.
Naiyaho mbege emoi.
Nti, "Nyina amalemwa.
Ndugile kutunda."

Lyagoba nka mambwenu bwaigolo.
Yatuluka n' ogw' ekibanga.
Yagileta Bunuzi bwa lushakala,
Kashunshu kelagalile,
Balezi mwenyooma kayogele,
Bailukilwa omwooyo,
Oliiba-mitima.
. Yanyekolela Ihabula.
Ngenyi mulumalume.
Galukila aho esitalwaho,
Eshube kisanja,

NOTES

183 Bloodbrother is used figuratively here, as it is in other places, to connote intimacy and solidarity.

184 This is similar to Kajango's self-praise quoted on line 161.1: "He-who-knows-himself eats not the food of children. . . " The contrast is between beer, the drink of adults, and sweet mash, ripe-banana juice, the drink of children. It is said that drinking sweet mash can make a grown man impotent.

185 Recall it was the wife herself who offered sweet mash to Kajango (on line 167.2)

187 The folding and the draw-in-wrestling are metaphors for positions in lovemaking. In the folding, lovers embrace while facing each other in a seated position, their bodies folded at the waist; it is said to be the position of young lovers. According to Haya wrestling rules, a real draw between men grappling with each other occurs if they fall together on their sides, and their shoulders touch the ground at the same time. In the tie-in-wrestling position, lovers embrace face-to-face lying on their sides, with the woman's right thigh beneath the man's left; it is said to be the position favored by married couples.

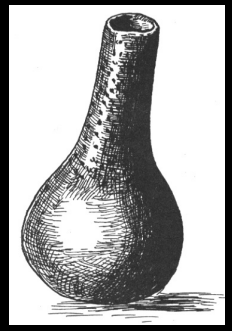
ILLUSTRATIONS

They sigh covetously at what they cannot carry
On Nyabeteka mountain in Luhanga.

I heard two clans fill the entrance.
I said, "What is it, my wife?"
my child, I knew she was powdering herself at the hearth.
Her private vessel she took from beside the bed–
They call it by the name of *Off-they-race*.

When she lay down
She found me escorted off by snoring.
"Father, king who rules all peoples, elder,
Turn to me, dear one, my bloodbrother.
Aren't you *Drinks-not-as-a-child*?
My husband, *Drinker-of-fermented-brew*, say who gave sweet mash to you, and you agreed?"

That day she continued,
"*Lover-of-the-folding*,
Lover-of-the-draw-in-wrestling,
Come let's fold each other–
Young ones fold,
The elders draw in wrestling."



180 A woman's private vessel, about 6" tall, which she receives at marriage and uses for pre-lovemaking ablutions. It is praised here as Off-they-racebecause it heats the needed water so quickly.

Basinda ekyobatatwaala
Nyabeteka eibanga lya Luhanga

Nkahulila eilembo limoi yalijuza enganda ibili.
Nti, "Mawe mukazi wabaki?"
Bojo nkasiga nayekalaba omu mwanya.
Ensiba ya wenene yagihya omu bibazi.
Mbagyeeta eibala lya Basilibutuka.

Kayagiile kunyiama
Yashanga nashagalwa ekigono.
"Tata, Mukama atwaala abantu boona, mugulusi,
Kubuka baba, munyawanyi wange.
Nowa *Lutanywa-g'abaana*?
Mushaija *Anywa-maalwa*, gamba ayakuha omulamba okakunda."

Kilo ekyo,
"*Lugonza-kukunja*,
Lugonza-Kugwaamaate,
Ija tukunjagane -
Abato bakunjagala,
Abakulu bagwa amaate."

POETIC STANZAS

187-187.4: compound stanza in **aba**, 2 + 1 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets composed as ..."the folding"/..."falling together" (**a**'s:186-186.1, 186.3-186.4) separated by a single line that includes "to fold" but inflected in the subjuntive (**b**: 186.2).

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 190.1-222:

In the morning Kajango falls into a swoon as though dead (lines 190.1-193.1). The couple's child runs to the fields where the wife has gone to work and calls to the mother, telling her of Kajango's dire condition, and cursing her by invoking named spirits; each spirit is praised with its characteristic praise. The bard elaborates this praise by asserting that the same spirit is known by different names in different kingdoms (lines 194-221). The mother apparently curses her child with a single line.

NOTES

196 This episode is the generically marked Call and contains the major themes of the ballad. It is an apparently unthinkable scene, one in which a child curses its own mother. But a moment's reflection in Haya belief reveals cultural dissonances in the apparent horror that assure all is well, or at least, not as serious as it might seem. Calling on a spirit to injure someone, as the child is doing, is called oku-tega, and one usually does this in secret, at the spirit's shrine, not in the open fields before others. Moreover, the spirits the child primarily calls upon first, Nyakalembe is a beneficent fertility figure. One could never curse with her. But the most significant dissonance is that, according to traditional belief, one cannot curse (oku-tega) a woman. This is because the curse is an instrument of traditional property relations, a guarantor of contracts and a reprisal for theft. But women are not party to this system, because in it, they cannot own property. In another old ballad, Kabundu gulikiile "the pleasing shortness," a man tries to curse a woman for breaking a promise, but is told by one spirit after another that it is not possible. Such a curse, as soon emerges, is the issue in this ballad as well, namely, whether Kajango has been cursed and fallen into a life-threatening state. But Kajango does not "eat" indiscriminately like a child, nor has he "eaten" anything from another, that is, he has not incurred any debts that would make him vulnerable to a curse. And so one who is versed in these matters knows even at this point that, no matter how dire the circumstances appear, Kajango has been cursed by no one, not even his wife, and will recover.

I said, "Don't bother me.
I'm tired.
I've come from trading."
Yai ya-a-a
We lay down, we slept.

When night had risen,
She went to cultivate.
When she had gone to cultivate
–Was there in the planted fields–
I fainted dead away.
I fainted as in sickness.

The child I had with her
Went running
And found her in the planted fields.

He said, "Mother! Mother! Mother! You!"
He said, "Be stopped from cultivating! May Nyakalembe strike you down!"
He said, "May she strike you down. May she strike you down completely."
He said, "And may Ilimamabuye
Bury you in a tilled field."

On Bumbile Island they call her Kikuli.
They call her *Promise-keeper*.
They her call *Ashes-of-Burnt-Grass*.
In Ihangilo they call her *Baboon-killer*.

Nti, "Otanyita kubi.
Nyina amalemwa.
Ndugile kutunda."
Yai ya-a-a
Twanyaama twanagila.

K'obwile bwakeile,
Yagya kulima.
Olwo yalugile kulima,
Akaba akyali aha musili,
Nakaba bukaba.
Nakaba nk' omulwaile.

Omwaana nkaba nimuzala na wenene.
Yagenda ailukile.
Yamushanga omu musili.

Ahi, "Mawe! Mawe! Mawe! Iwe!"
Ahi, "Kalimululwe!Nyakalembe akwiite!"

Ahi, "Akwiite, akwiitile kimoi"

Ahi, "Ilimamabuye
Akuziike omu ndimilo."

Bumbile bamweeta *Kikuli*.
Bamweeta *Nyabusaana*.
Bamweeta *Nyabuyonga*.
Ihangilo bamweeta *Kiita-nkobe*.

201 As he does elsewhere, the bard Muzee elaborates a panorama of possessing spirits, describing how their names and epithets vary with the geography of Hayaland. His poetry envisions a systematic set of underlying identities between overtly different spiritual manifestations in the named kingdoms and locations.

202 Epithets for spirits generally refer to aspects of their myths of origin, their characteristic effects on living humans, and/or their characteristic speech and behavior when they posses their spirit mediums. Many of the epithets are difficult for me to explicate with certainty.

POETIC STANZAS

190.1-193.1: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2, formed by couplets that cohere by enjambment and begin with an adverbial past perfect (**a**'s: 190.1-190.2, 191-192) contrasted with a couplet that coheres by parallelism and repeats "I fainted" in initial position in each line (**b**:193-193.1).

194-195.1: stanza in **abb** formed by contrast between lines with a similarly inflected verb in initial position (**b**'s: 195-195.1) and a single line with different, and marked, tenses (**a**: 194).

196-200: stanza in **aa**a**b** formed by contrast between lines that begin with a locutive (**a**'s: 196-199) and one line that does not (**b**: 200).

201-202.2: stanza in **abba** formed by contrast between lines composed as placename + "they call her" + spirit name (**a**'s: 201, 202.2) and lines composed as "they call her" spirit name (**b**'s: 202, 202.1).

NOTES

213 Ruler . . . and Straightener refer to Kajango in this context. They usually are epithets that praise a king, who judicially, ritually, or militarily has the power and the responsibility to set things straight. Here the image valorizes a husband, father, and head of a household.

POETIC STANZAS

203-205: stanza in **ab**bbbb**a** formed by contrast between lines composed as placename + "she is" + praisename (**a**'s: 203, 205) and lines composed as praisenames alone (**b**'s: 204-204.3).

206-209.1: stanza in **abab**xxxx formed by contrast between lines composed as place descriptor + "among" + people descriptor (**a**'s: 206, 208) and lines composed as "call her" + praisename (207, 208.1); plus four praisenames (**x**'s: 208.1-209.1).

210-211.1: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 2, each couplet begining with a subjunctive verb, formed in **aab** by two couplets whose lines cohere semantically, being comprised of sentences associated by topic (**a**'s: 210-210.1, 210.2-210.3-spiritual disease and social ostracism, respectively) contrasted with one couplet (**b**: 211-211.1) whose lines cohere by enjambment in the concatenation of praisenames.

213-215.1: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines comprised of praise of Kajango (**a**'s: 213, 215) and lines comprised of the child's address to his mother (**b**'s: 214, 215.1).

216-218: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines composed as body part + "brought forth" + effluent (**a**'s: 216, 217) and a line composed as body part + "was cold" (**b**: 218).

221-221.4: compound stanza in **aba**, 2 + 1 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets (**a**'s: 221-221.1, 221.3-221.4, which cohere internally by parallel composition as ...potable liquid...+ verb, and body part + verb phrase, respectively) and a single intervening line (**b**: 221.2).

In Kihanja she is *Shaker-out-of-the-sheep's-Buttocks*,
Water-furrow
Of-the-Buffalo
Swampy-sand.
In Karagwe she is *Father of Wounds*.
Ah-ya-a-a

In Kiziba, the home of measured speech,
They call her Nyabuleza *Food-bringer*.
At our home, among us Bankango
We call her by the name of *Whiskers in which paper wasps are hidden.*
Pruning hook that chops among the branches,
Relentless one of the beehive,
Great arms that subdue all.

"May she hit you with her leather kilt.
If you do not die, become an invalid.
Embracing, may you be met by a backside.
In Kyamutwaala may all know you well!
May you see the *Stealer of things not hers*,
Who comes not in diviner's dreams."
Weye-e-e

"The Ruler of all peoples, the Straightener.
–Come and let me show you, mother–
The man who drinks fermented brew,
I saw them giving him sweet banana mash.

His mouth dripped bile.
His nose dripped mucus.
His solar plexes . . .[were cold]

Stop for tape change

Ya-a-a

Be stopped from cultivating! Be slain by her!"
He said, "I saw them give him milk. He refused.
But sweet mash - no! no! - that's what he drank
My kings!
His mouth dripped bile.
His nose became cold."

Kihanja ni *Kikunkumula-ntaama*
Mabununkungulu
Lyanyakabogo
Mishenyeelendemwile.
Kalagwe ni *IsheNgoga*.
Ah-ya-a-a

Kiziba omwa *Njegu*
Bamweeta *NyabulezaKaishakila*.
Omwaitu omu Bankango
Tumweeta eibala lya *Bileju Ayalikwamu enwa*.

Enkolomboizo ashenya omu mashonjole.
Lukaluka lya Luzinga,
Bikono bya ifunga.

"Akuteze akakanda
K'oliba otafile osheege.
Ofumbate akuteile ekinyio.
Kyamutwaala bakwekomyege boona!
Olebe *Ayaibil' ezitalize*,
Lutachunzibwa iwe."
Weye-e-e

"*Mukama atwaala abantu boona*, *Mugolozi*
Ija ondebese mawe,
Omushaija Anywa-amaalwa.
Nasiga bamuha omulamba.

Akanwa kaleta efununtu
Enyindo zaleta ebiinzi.
Akalega...[yahola hololo]

Stop for tape change

Ya-a-a

Kalimululwe! Akwite!"
Ahi, "Nasiga bamuhaile amata yaganga.
N' omulamba - chei! chei! - nigwo alikunywa
Bakama bange!
Akanwa kaleta efununtu.
Enyindo zaba hololo."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 223-52:
With her hoe held in a way to indicate distress, the wife returns from the field and goes to investigate, finding her husband in a dangerous state (lines 223-238). She strengthens her resolve (lines 239-40.3) and prepares to visit spirit mediums for consultations by gathering cowry-shell currency and twigs useful for divining.

NOTES

222 The mother responds to the child's putative curse by saying politely -- if that is possible -- the equivalent of "drop dead."

225 Snapping the fingers by pressing middle finger to thumb, leaving the index finger loose and flicking one's wrist is a gesture of dismay.

229 Once legendary kings, Bachwezi became a pantheon of spirits who possess ritual specialists and give them powers to treat health and social problems.

230 A woman walking with her hoe pointed to the sun signals her distraught state and appeals to that spirit for help.

234 They are parted, that is, Kajango's soul (omwoyo) and his body have separated.

POETIC STANZAS

223-224: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines of quoted speech introduced by a locutive (**a**'s: 223-223.1) and a line of quoted speech not so introduced (**b**: 224).

225-225.2: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines composed as verb initial + "my fingers together" (**a**'s: 225, 225.1) and a line composed as verb initial + verb (**b**: 225.2).

230-234.2: compound stanza, 1 + 7 + 2 + 4 + 1, formed in **axbba** by single lines composed as [verb] + "hoe" + "mine" + verb + "toward the sun" (**a**'s: 230, 234.1) contrasted with linegroups composed as "when I did" + verb phrase/ independant clause (**b**'s: 231-232, 233-233.3; the two-line composition of the former is expanded to four lines in the latter); to the first line (**a**: 230) is appended a list of seven praisenames (**x**'s: 230.1-230.7).

"May lamentations be raised for you, my child."

He said, "He does not speak."
He said, "I saw that all the clans arrived.
We were so many that the banana shoots were trampled."

I snapped one finger on another,
I cracked one finger on another,
Until my joints began to swell.

That day, Provider,
Ha-a-a

Aya-ya
"Mother do not kill me.
Consult Bachwezi spirits."

I came with my hoe pointed at the Sun,
Great branches of Luhuga,
Child of others,
Wakens at dawn,
Not long in foot,
He favors raised, imploring palms,
Child of others,
Among elders he speaks.

When I came up our walkway,
I found the place filled with people.
When I met my husband's sister,
She said, "Mother, the *Lover-of-the-folding*, the *Lover-of-the-draw-in-wrestling*
She said, "See, your husband, the *Folder*:
Now they have separated."
She said, "They are parted."

My hoe I planted, still directed at the Sun.
Investigating, I found my husband laid out near the hearth.

"Mwaana wange kabikwe ikonola."

Ahi, "Takigamba."
Ahi, "Nasiga enganda zoona zagobile.
Twagwa n'omulugusha gw'engemu twaguhenda."

Natwaala olukumu aha lundi,
Nateela olukumu aha lundi
Nalulwaaza kanyananga

Kil' ekyo, Lugaba.
Ha-a-a

Aya-ya
"Mawe otanyita.
Ogenda nolaguza abachwezi boona."

Nkaija emfuka yange ngilalalikile omwa Kazoba,
Bishonga bya Luhuga,
Muto w' abandi,
Kalamuka lukyakya,
Omutalaihya bilenge,
. Omutegelwa biganja akabyenda,
Muto w' abandi,
Omu bakulu yagamba nabo.

Kanagiile kwija omu kibuga,
Nshanga kibanga eki lwabaijulilane.
Kanagiile kubuganwa mulamukazi wange,
Ahi, "Mawe, *Lugonza-kukunja*, *Lugonza-kugwaamaate*"

Ati, "Leba omushaija *Mukunjagala*
Mbwenu bagonga."
Ahi, "Bagungilaine."

Emfuka yange nagisimba omwa Kazoba.
Natokatokomba nshanga bamunyiamikile omu mwanya omushaija wa'.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 253-86:
The wife consults a series of spirits through their human mediums. Each is identified with its characteristic praise epithets. None are successful in divining the cause of the husband's state.

NOTES

240 Women customarily wail in grief to respond to and to announce the death of a loved one. The wife carefully does not do this lest Kajango's soul be startled and flee and become permanently severed from his body.

240.2 Women moving around in stiff fiber work skirts is an image of self-conscious caution: they must move carefully lest the stiff skirts tip up to reveal their nakedness.

245 Twigs are read by a diviner as embodiments of the various forces and agents that affect a particular household.

253 Bwogi when alive was the son and successor of King Kalemela of Kymutwara. He died and became a possessing spirit. There are many different versions of his characteristic praise.

POETIC STANZAS

235-238.1: compound stanza 2 + 2 + 2, formed in **aab** by contrast between couplets composed as ["when"] "I touched" + "on" + body part/ verb initial independent clause (**a**'s: 235-236, 237-237.1) and a couplet composed as vocable/ noun (body part) initial independent clause (**b**'s: 238-238.1).

239-240.3: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 1, formed in **aab** by contrast between couplets (**a**'s: 239-240, 240.1-240.2, which cohere internally as question /answer and as expressions of wife's caring, respectively) and a single line (**b**: 240.3) that indicates the wife's readiness.

241-243: compound stanza in **aba**, 2 + 2 + 1 formed by contrast between verb initial narrative lines with unmarked (near past) tenses (**a**'s: 241-241.1, 243) and verb initial lines of asides in marked (present and distant past) tenses (**b**: 424-424.1).

245-250: compound stanza in **aba**, 1 + 4 + 1, formed by contrast between single lines composed as verb phrase + "all (kinds of) twigs" (**a**'s: 245, 250, reversed order in the latter) and four lines (**b**'s: 246-249) that are structured in turn as **aaab** by contrast between lines with initial nouns (**a**'s: 246-248) and a line with an initial verb (**b**: 249).

253-255.1: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 2, formed in **abb** by couplets that cohere by parallelism (**b**'s: 254.1-254.2, 255-255.1) - composition as verb phrase + sun phase (reversed in second line) and as placename + "it is said" + adverb, respectively - contrasted with a couplet that coheres by enjambment of placename appositives (**a**: 253-254).

I touched him on the mouth.
I find it drips bile.
When I touched him on the solar plexis,
He was cold, cold, cold.
Yo-o-o
His anus dripping ooze.

What shall I do?
I did not wail in grief
Lest I sever my husband's soul.
I moved self-consciously, as women do in raffia skirts.
I took hold of my resolve.

I clambered on the bed.
I got his spear.
You know we women save together with our men:
We had a thousand cowries in the roof peak.
I poked them down and did not bother counting.

When I went outside with them,
And I walked around the farm,

I cut all kinds of twigs:
The *mutongo* vine is first for divining.
Small-fruit *mutula*; I cut from the *mulinzi* shrub.
A *mutunzo*.
I hurried and cut *mushambya*.
All kinds of twigs I bundled into bundles.

I'll go make divination. He will not die.
My man has never eaten from another, Lujoge.

Bwogi's place is first,
In Kimbugu of Businga:
Cut goat's hooves in the morning,
In the evening they go to cultivate.
In Buzinja it's said with broken words.
In Kyamutwaala it's said in lamentation.

Nakola omu kanwa.
Nshanga kaleta efununtu.
Kanakola omu kalega,
Yahola holoholo.
Yo-o-o
Oluhende lwaleta eleguulegu.

Ngile ntai?
Tintemu ndulu.
Ntagutula omwooyo gw' omushaija wange.
Nkagenda ninyemanya nka abakazi n'ebishenshe.
Nabanza okukwata kwekomage.

Natemba ekitabo
Naihyaho eichumu lya wenene.
Nomanya abakazi tubiika n' abashaija:
Tukaba twina olukumi lw' ensimbi omu lushwi.
Naishokya tinabazile.

Kanatulukile na zo',
Nkagenda omu kibanga.

Natema emiti yoona.
Nyakatongo niwe wa mbele.
Nyakatula natema nyakalinzi.
Nyakatunzo.
Nailuka natema nyakashambya.
Ebiti byoona nabitiganda enganda.

Kangye ndaguze taafe.
Owange takalyaaga ka muntu *Lujoge*.

Omwa Bwogi nimwo mwa mbele,
Kimbugu kya Businga:
Chwa amagembe bwankya,
Bwaigolo gagya kulima.
Buzinja egambwa etobokwa.
Kyamutwaala egambwa eyobobo.

NOTES

261 Kimuli was the first born of King Kalemela. His murder by jealous cowives sent Kalemela into a rage.

271.2 Kasana's gait, pouring himself along is stereotyped movement of members of the ruling clans.

POETIC STANZAS

256-258.1: two three-line mirror stanzas formed by composition as "he killed" + masculine direct object (256, 257) and ..."they did not eat"...(256.1, 257.1), and by semantic equivalence of acts of mourning (256.2, 258.1).

271-271.4: compound stanza, 1 + 2 + 2, formed in **abb** by couplets composed as place or person designation + relative inflection of verb "to know"/ "call her" + praisename (**b**'s: 271.1, 271.3) contrasted with a single line composed differently.

She's lost a husband with a big penis.
The women did not eat.
I heard vaginas in the village gathered in lament.
'She's been bereaved of the Testicle-Shaker.'
I saw they did not eat.
Hiyo-o-o
Near the hearth, the women lay with empty cooking pots.

He did the water oracle for me.
He said, "He will not die. He's eaten nothing."
I scorned the man's words.
I snatched from him the consultation fee.

I'll go to Kimuli
Hot Head . . .
Broken-plant-shoot of Kalemela
Why-do they-bother-me and They-break-me
Obscene-speech-of-the-Baziba
Long stick of the crow
Bird of the Apportioner of Elephants

He cuts the Bull on its back.
Hayah
He-e-e he-e-e
A Spotted-one, a king,
Elder bull
Ha-a-a
Bead-cutter you are.
Ha-a-a a Bull

Appear, *Of-the-Bracelet*
Sweet smell of rotting wood, in rainy season you make sheep cough.

He did the water oracle for me.
He didn't settle anything.

I'll go to Kasana's.
In Ihangilo those who do not know him
Call him Kasana, *pouring himself along*.
But we who know him
Call him *Katete*-grass, *whistling in the wind*.

He did the water oracle for me.
He didn't settle anything.

Akaita omushaija we mbolo mpango.
Abakazi tibabilile.
Nkashanga emana omu kyalo itekile ekibobo.
Akaita Luchunda-magosi.
Nashanga tibabilile bakama bange.
Hiyo-o-o
Abakazi omu mwanya bakalala kayogoolekano.

Yanteelaho ebiizi.
Ahi, "Taafe takalyaaga kantu
Nabigaya omushaija
Namwaka emikimba.

Oleke ngobe Kimuli
Mukanga gwa nyawatoneile
Ihenda-mitenga gwa Kalemeela
Omu Bufiileki na Bwampenda
W' ensheegu w' Abazib'
Oluti lwa Kashonge
Lw' enyanyonyi za mugaba njoju

Engundu natema mugongo
Haya
He-e-e he-e-e
Ngondo mukama,
Engundu nkulu
Ha-a-a
Nyabuchwa-nkwanzi iwe.
Ha-a-a Ngundu,

Habuka *Lwantwiiga,*
Migaju okoza enyana katoigo.

Yanteelaho ebiizi
Tiyamala kantu

Kangye omwa Kasaana
Ihangilo abatamumanya
Bamweeta *Kasaana olusheshekana nanka*.
Kandi ichwe abamumanya
Tumweeta *katete ka nyaiwaga*.

Yanteelaho ebiizi.
Tiyamala kantu.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 287-310:
On her way home, the wife bemoans her condition aloud (lines 287-95). An old woman overhears her; she questions the wife about her loss (lines 296-305) and recommends a person for her to see.

NOTES

288 A cattle path is larger and better traveled than a footpath and one is more likely to be overheard there.

290 Not being able to mourn publicly suggests that the deceased was a secret lover. While not the case, the wife is questioned about this several times.

POETIC STANZAS

274-276: compound stanza, 1 + 4 + 4, formed in **abb** by contrast between a single line (**a**: 274) and two quatrains, each of which is structured in turn as **abba** - the first by contrast between lines composed as placename + "is" + spirit name (**a**'s: 274, 275.2) and lines composed as "they call her" + spirit name (**b**'s: 275, 275.1); the second by contrast between lines composed as placename + "is" + spirit name (**a**'s: 275.3, 276) and lines composed as spirit name alone (**b**'s: 275.4, 275.5)

283-286: verse passage of four sections (253-260.2, 262-270.3, 271-272.1, 273-286), each composed of: visiting a particular spirit medium (253, 262, 271, 273), praising the spirit (254-258.1, 262.1-270.1, 271.1-271.4, 274-277.3), doing the water oracle (259, 270.2, 272, 278-279, and learning the result (260, 270.3, 272.1, 285); two passages are interpolated - taking back a consultation fee (260.1-260.2) and lamenting (280-284.1); two lines complete the passage as a whole (285.1-285.2).

293-295.1: stanza in **aabb** formed by contrast between lines that have "eat" as their main verb (**a**'s: 293, 294) and lines that have "settle up" as their main verb (**b**'s: 295, 295.1)

I run and arrive at Ilimamabuye's.
On Bumbile Island she is Kikuli.
They call her *Promise-keeper*.
They call her *Ashes-of-Burnt Grass*.
In Ihangilo she is *Baboon-Killer*.

In Kihanja, *Shaker-out-of-sheep's-buttocks*,
Water-furrow,
Swampy-sand.
In Karagwe she is *Father of Wounds*.

And in Kabale we name her *Whiskers*
In which paper wasps are hidden,
Pruning hook that chops among the branches,
Relentless one of the beehive,
Great arms that subdue all.

He did the water oracle for me.
He did the water oracle for me.

On that day.
What shall I do?
My man . . .

I cried aid from the Sun,
Great branches of Luhuga
Child of others

I heard the oracle refuse.
I consulted Bachwezi. I used them all.
Now what shall I do?

When I was returning,
On a cattle path one shouldn't reveal one's woes.
I said, "My kings . . .
I cannot bewail what has been stolen.
I am bereaved of a husband."

Ho-o-o

Rather than eat of love,
Eat something bitter from a spirit;
You promise and in a growing-season settle the debt.
But wondrous love's debt never has been settled by a human.

Nyiluka ngoba omwa Ilimamabuye.
Bumbile ni Kikuli.
Bamweeta *Nyabusaana*
Bamweeta *Nyabuyonga*
Ihangilo ni *Kiita-nkobe*.

Kihanja ni *Kikunkumula-ntaamamabunu*,
Nkungulu
Mishenyeelendemwile.
Kalagwe ni Ishengoga.

Kandi Kabale tumweeta ibala lya *Bileju*.
Ayalikwamu enwa,
Enkolomboizo eshenya omu mashonjole,
Bitaluka bya Muzinga,
Bikono bya ifunga.

Yanteelaho ebiizi.
Yanteelaho ebiizi iwe

Wewe kil' ekyo.
Ngile ntai?
Omushaija...

Natakila Kazoba,
Bishonga bya luhuga
Muto w' abandi

Nkahulila byayanga.
Nalaguza abachwezi namalayo.
Mbwenu ngile ntai?

Kanabaile ningaluka,
Omu luhongolelo tilwekenelwamu.
Nti, "Bakama bange inye
Naibwa ekyo ntatake.
Naita omushaija."

Ho-o-o

Olw' okulya ak' engonzi,
Olya ak' omuchwezi ashalile;
Omulaga ekilimo omutegulila.
Engonzi kichoncho tikategulilwaga muntu."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 311-42.1:
The wife travels as advised (lines 311-318.1), and out in the open fields she comes upon the agricultural spirits Nyakalembe and Ilimamabuye singing women's songs (lines 319-28.1). Nyakalembe questions the wife, praising her virtue and that of love.

NOTES

300 The string tie of the woman's work skirt is cutting into her flesh; this and other signs indicate that she has gone for a long time without relaxing and tending to her body at home.

320 These are fragments of familiar songs sung at weddings. The first is about the importance of maintaining the health and cleanliness of one's body. The second praises the bride on her procession to her husband's house. Here they are sung by disembodied spirits.

POETIC STANZAS

296.1-299: compound stanza, 1 + 2 + 2, formed in **abb** by contrast between a single line (**a**: 296) and couplets (**b**'s: 296.1-297, 298-299) that cohere semantically as requests for explanation (296.1, 299) based on observations of evidence (297, 298).

300-302: three lines composed as ...item contiguous to body + verb final; initial words on each line create alternate patterns of **abb** (contrasting an initial verb with its absence) **aba** (contrasting an initial prepositional phrase with its absence) and **aab** (contrasting a term of address with its absence).

306-310: stanza in **axxabb** formed by contrast between a couplet whose lines cohere as 2nd person subjunctive verb initial (**a**'s: 306,308) and a couplet whose lines cohere as third person indicative verb initial (**b**'s: 309-310); interpolated within the first couplet is a pair of repeated, thematic lines (**x**'s: 307-307.1).

An old woman stood among the plantain trees.
She said, "What's wrong, my child?
For you speak aloud what's in your heart.
Can you not bewail what has been stolen?
Are you bereaved of a husband or a lover?

I see your raffia skirt has left its mark.
Your hair stands on end.
My lady, dust clings to you.

Your belly's gone for four and four, eight days–today, the ninth–
It seems you have nothing inside."
Shi-i-i
She said, "I've lost a husband."

"Do not mourn. But go.
Your husband will not die.
He has not eaten from another.
Go down to Mishenye at Lwemihanda's.
There dwells a man who sees the future.
He'll tell the truth to you."

Then the low road I took down to Kigabilo.
I went toward Kitobo.
Ho-o-o
Kabula-ishoke.
At Kyanyabakaikulu I descended.
I came by the road to lower Kigabilo.
I crossed over.
At Nziba,
Lugasha I passed through.

When I took the road to Kajumilo,
Straight for the big open fields there,
I hear people joyous–
Like herders who have brought their cattle to the gate.

They sang, "If it's dead, toss it.
The rotten one has none to bury it."
I said, "What shall I do?"
I hear women's song:
"The white mushroom is happy. You are happy in your reign.
If the King precedes us
In the wilderness, what is there for us to fear?"

Omukaikulu agya ayema omu ngemu.
Ahi, "Wabaki mwaana wange?
Nka wayegamba agali omu mwooyo.
Waibwa eky' otatake?
Waita omushaija angili mugenda waawe?

Nimbona ekishenshe kyakunyoile
Omu mutwe eishoke lyawe lyashungwile.
Waitu enzilo zakukwete.

Akalega wamala binai munana; mbwenu kya mwenda,

Nkanoshana atakalyaaga kantu munda."
Shi-i-i
Ahi, "Naita omushaija."

"Otakuchula, ogalukile aha.
Omushaija waawe taafe.
Takalyaaga ka'muntu.
Osongoke Mishenye omwa Lwemihanda.
Alim' omushaija nabasha.
Alakugambil' eby' amazima."

Aho empalo nkakongokela eya Kigabilo.
Nakwata Kitobo.
Ho-o-o
Kabula-ishoke.
Omuli Kyanyabakaikulu nasooka.
Naija omuhanda gwa Kigabilo aha nsi.
Nashabuka.
Omuli Nziba,
Lugasha nalabamu.

Kanabaile nakwata omuhanda gwa Kajumilo,
Kugya kwemeleza omu lweeya oluhango,
Mpulila abalikweela
Nka abatwete ente aha lwigi.

Bakwese, "Kyafa naga.
Kyatokoma kyabulwa abaziiki."
Nti, "Ngile ntai?"
Mpulila empundu,
Bati, "Kanyahwela yela. Noyela omu ngoma

Olw' Omukama yayebembeile
Omu ilungu, nitutiinayoki?

NOTES

325 Ta (Mr.) Dionies was the host of the event at which the poet sang.

332 Mother cow's call praises a woman who has borne a child. She behaves differently when she has become a mother, as cows do.

334 Love, which has cast the wife into her present situation, is praised in formulaic language

339 This is part of Kajango's self-praise (ebyebugo). It proclaims his virtue of self-knowledge: The person who knows himself does not eat as a child, that is, does not eat indiscriminately.

POETIC STANZAS

330.1-330.4: stanza in **abba** formed by contrast between lines composed as noun + verb (**a**'s: 330.1, 330.4) and lines composed as 2nd person verb + noun (**b**'s: 330.2, 330.3).

331-340: compound stanza, 2 + 12 + 1 + 2, formed in **abxa** by contrast between two couplets that constitute question and answer (**a**'s: 331-331.1 and 339-340) and six intervening couplets of praise that cohere internally (except for 336.4-336.5) by various parallelisms (**b**'s: 332-337.1); a single vocable line is interpolated between praise and answer (**x**: 338).

Look now!
But when I looked into the open fields
I saw no people there.
I saw only *shanje* grass and wilderness.

That man has been the death of me!
I've fallen in a place that's filled with spirits!
This day, today, I meet Nyakalembe face to face!

What I tell you did happen, Ta Dionies!
What I tell you did appear that day.
What I tell you did appear.

I saw Nyakalembe in the lead.
Ilimamabuye followed her.

When they came before me,
"You woman dressed in raffia skirt
Whose cinch has left its mark.
You're dusty.
You have the look of one who never swallows.
Your hair stands on end.

Can you not bewail what has been stolen?
Are you bereaved of a husand
Or are you bereaved of your lover?

Dear one, *Mother-cow's-call*
Dear one, *Shows-cheer-in-adversity*.
The deeds love does
Are those the spotted serpent speaks in the heart."

Soothing-warmth of an antelope pelt,
Bubbling-heat of a civet cat, .
Mosquitoes prick me like thorns, .
Breasts prick me like iron points. .
It falls on its back.
A leather kilt works.
Alight on me, you are a dainty one.
Come within, you are Kaihyula.
Wewe-e-e

"I've lost *Knows-himself*.
I've lost *Eats-not-the-food-of-children*."

A Spotted-one died in Bugabo.
He brought iron from Itahwa.

Banza olebe!"
Mbali ndeebile omu lweehya
Nabona abantu tibaliyo.
Ngya mbona omushanje n'eilungu.

Omushaija yanyita!
Nagwa omuli lwijulilaine!
Kilo ekya mbwenu nabuganganwa Nyakalembe!

Ekyo nagamba kyaba Ta Dionizi!
Ekyo nagamba kyaboneka kilo ekyo.
Ekyo nagamba kyaboneka.

Mbona Nyakalembe ayebembeile.
Ilimamabuye amuhondeile.

Kabangobile omu maisho,
"Iwe mukazi ajwet' ebishenshe
Omuguha gulakunyoile.
Olabaile nzilo.
Olabaile milambi.
Eishoke lyawe lilashongoile.

Kaishenu okaibwa eky' otatake?
Okaita omushaija
Anga okaita mugenda waawe?

Baba, *Mijuumilo*,
Baba, *Myemalaamalo*.
Eby' engonzi ikola
Nibyo bugondo egambila omu mwooyo."

Bugubugu ya akajobe,
Mokomoko ya akamondo,
Nsini zinkoza nka amawa,
Mabeele gankoza nk'emihunda.
Lugwa bugazi.
. Nkanda ikolela.
Hanantuka, oli kito.
Omu nda oije, oli Kaihyula
Wewe-e-e

"Nkaita *Nyamyemanyo*.
Nkaita *Lutalya-bya-baana*"

Kabamba yafa Bugabo.
Ekashomba ebyoma Itahwa.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 344-382:
The spirit instructs the wife to visit the high god Wamara (lines 344-52.3) and warns her not to fear what she sees at his palace compound.

NOTES

347 Wamara is the spirit-king of the Bachwezi pantheon. His style of movement (347.2-.3) shows his high social standing. Ndahula is his father.

353 Hare is the avenger because, as the hero of many animal fables, he usually repays the wrongs done against him.

358 Balanzi are a class of spirits, like Bachwezi, but they do not possess people nor are they sacrificed to. They can, however, harm people.

POETIC STANZAS

344-345: stanza in **aabb** formed by contrast between a couplet that coheres by enjambment of apposition (**a**'s: 344-344.1) and a couplet that coheres by close parallelism (**b**'s: 344.2-345).

346-347: stanza in **aabb** formed by contrast between a couplet that coheres by enjambment and repetition of "search for" (**a**'s: 346-346.1) and a couplet that coheres by parallelism and repetition of "go" (**b**'s: 346.2-347).

352.4-356: compound stanza, 1 + 2 + 2, formed in **aab** by contrast between lines that repeat "you will meet in there" (**a**'s: 352.4, 353-354; the latter coheres internally by composition as place description + "you will meet there" + animal name + praise) and a final couplet whose lines are closely parallel (**b**: 355-356).

356.1-358: stanza in **abcb** formed by contrast between lines composed as ..."they decant beer [in brewing,] the spirits" (**b**'s: 356.2, 358) and lines composed differently (**a**, **c**: 356.1, 359).

The bickering of women
That quickly overturned their reign.

They said, "Because you've told us everything–
You've lost your husband, not your lover–
You sit on the road's left side.
We'll sit on the road to the right.

You, wife in search of her husband,
In search of his soul where you were instructed,
Now don't go to another spirit.
Go to Wamara
Essential-Killer
Bows-and-Bends
Supple-one of Ndahula.
His son is Kagolo
Babbler/wobbler
Adorned with beads all over
Throws-himself-into-battle-with-warriors.

They cut it in Nongo wood,
It fell in Kabushekya.
Honey in the rock
Is not drawn out easily with fire.
He killed a man in Kihanja,
He boasted of it at his uncle's in Kiziba of the rock.

Now, now,
We'll tell the truth.

Go to Wamara
Essential-Killer
Bows-and-bends
Supple-one of Ndahula.

Do not fear what you will find there.
At the entrance road, you'll find Hare *the Avenger*..
When you reach the palace, you'll find Crow, *Big-Man with Claws*, guarding the door.
Great palace entrances are not of great concern
Small forecourts in the palace are of great concern.

Pass by Wamara's to the upper section of the farm,
Where brewing spirits decant beer, the Balanzi.
As you pass, fear not, do not be shaken.
You'll find them decanting beer, the Balanzi.

Ewengawenge y' abakazi
Ekabaaka engoma bwangu.

Bati, "Olwo watugambila byoona:
Okaita mushaija waawe, ti mugenda waawe,
Shuntama omuhanda olubaju lwa bumosho.
Ichwe tushuntame omuhanda olubaju lwe bulyo.

Iwe mukazi alikuhiga omushaija waawe,
Nogya kuhiga omwooyo mbali bakugambile.
Mbwenu otakugenda aha muchwezi ondijo.
Ogende omwa Wamala
Lwanyakwisa
Olukwinamile
Oluyongo lwa Ndahula.
Omutabani Kagolo
Buchecheeba
Buhunzile bwoona
Nshando za Lutumbika-manzi.

Babutema Nongo,
. Bwagwela Kabushekya.
Bwoki w' eibale
Ntahakulwa mpango na mulilo.
Omuntu yamwita Kihanja
Yamwetonda amaihwa Kiziba bw' omu ibale.

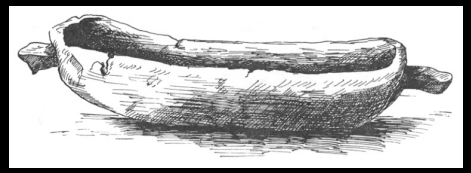
Mbwenu mbwenu
Tukugambile eky' amazima.

Ogye omwa Wamala
Lwa Nyakwisa
Olukwinamile
Oluyongo lwa Ndahula.

Eby' olashangamu otabitiina.
Nyalulembo olashangamu Nyakami *Nyamyehoolo.*
K'olaija kwija nyaluju, olashangamu Kikoona, *Kishaija kya Manono*, kilinzile ekigi.
Nyalulembo mpango tegil' ebihango.
Nyakabuga nke niyo egil' ebihango.

Olabamu omwa Wamala ekibanga kya lugulu
Okwo bayalula amaalwa kujunga Abalanzi.
Kolaleebayo otakutiina okachundwa.
Olashanga bayalula amaalwa Abalanzi.

ILLUSTRATIONS



360 Eijungilo, fermentation vessel, used in beer brewing



360 Young men add water to a fermentation vessel.



361 Here a young man steps into a vat of banana-sorghum beer mash

Ha-a-a
360 For a fermentation vat, they use a grave.
Frog steps one foot into the tub.
Chameleon draws off mash.
Human shin-bone is the funnel.
Human blood is the mash.
365 They've woven together a dead man's ribs–that's the sieve, My kings!–
The brewing sieve for squeezing out the mash.



362 Not a chameleon but brewer Fransi Kato in 1970



363 The funnel here is made of a calabash

Ha-a-a
360 Eijungilo, mbajungila omu nyanga.
Ekikele kyemeleize kugulu kumoi omu bwaato.
Embalaaluju netaha omulamba.
Omulundi gw' omutu nigwo mwitizo.
Obwamba bw' abantu nigwo mulamba.
365 Basibilila embaju z' omuntu afile nizo obugwi, Bakama bange!
Bugwi bw' amaalwa nigikamula omulamba.



365 Expressing beer mash from banana-straw mixture with a woven wooden sieve



365 Preparing the mash mixture on the sieve

POETIC STANZAS

360-370.2: mirror stanzas (360-365.1, 366-370.2) each formed by couplets that cohere by parallelism (361-362, 363-364, and 366-367, 368-369), each completed by couplets that cohere by enjambment of apposition (365-365.1, 370-370.1), while the passage as a whole is begun and ended by single lines (360, 370.2).

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 383-419:
The wife goes to Wamara's palace compound and finds what she was warned about.

NOTES

367 Beer seats seem to be analogical extensions of the seats in a lake canoe to something in a beer canoe, or fermentation vat, but I cannot identify them.

375 A woman would protect her modesty by folding her raffia skirt and sitting down on her haunches.

384.1 Muziba used here suggests that the crow is the clan-brother totem of the Baziba clan, but I cannot confirm this. Muziba can also refer to any citizen of the northern kingdom of Kiziba.

380 Shumaalamu is the greeting that a grown, married man is privileged to use.

ILLUSTRATIONS



366 Here the medium for expressing the mash is straw.



368 A young man uses a rope tied beside the vat to steady his balance.

Hair is medium for the mix.
Human heads, the beer seats.
Snakes are the working ropes tied to tubs.
A man laid out, the stone they grind the sorghum on.
But the sorghum that they grind–
They're grinding human eyes.
A human palm, the upper millstone.

Do not fear. Enter. Tread lightly.
Go there and enter in.
You'll find him seated on a copper stool.
Remember: Do not fear.

If events confound you, sit down: fold your raffia skirt in the palace.
Woi
Fold your raffia skirt.
Wewe-e-e

Go, fold your raffia skirt and kneel.
Go, say your salutations like a man.
Say, 'Shumaalamu, Provider, Shumaalamu.'
Go, hear the way he answers you, *Essential-Killer* Wamara.
Hear the way he answers you."

I shuffled along and reached the Crow.
"*Father Big-man with Claws*
I know you are a Muziba.
I go to salute King Wamara."
He said, "I grant you my permission. Don't let your feet delay."

When I had come, I met Hare *the Avenger.*
He said, "I grant you my permission. Don't let your feet delay."

POETIC STANZAS

371-374: stanza in **abba**: presence of "do not fear"

375-382: compound stanza in **aba**, 2 + 2 + 2, (lines 376-378 are interpolated and do not figure in the larger structure, although the alternation of vocables recapitulates it); first and last couplets cohere by marked repetition, incremental and reiterative; the middle coupled coheres semantically as named speech and quoted speech.

383-388: mirror stanzas that share a final line; the first is the elaborated one

Eishoke nilyo ijungyo.
Emitwe y' abantu bitebe by' amaalwa.
Enjoka nizo miguha nikoma ah' amaato.
Omuntu agalamile nilwo lubengo nibasa omugusha.
Kyonka omugusha 'gwo balikusa -
Nibasa amaisho g' abantu.
Ekiganja nsheiso ly' engomba.

Otabitiina otahemu otoogatooge.
Ogende ogye obitahemu.
Olashanga aikalile entebe y' omulinga.
Mala otakubitiina.

Kabilakushobeza oteele ekishenshe nyaluju.

Woi
Oteele ekishenshe.
Wewe-e-e

Ogye oteele ekishenshe obandame
Ogye olamye nka abashaija
Ohi, 'Shumaalamu, Lugaba, Shumaalamu.'
Ogye ohulile okwo alakuholoola, *Lwanyakwisa* Wamala.
Ohulile okwo alakuholoola."

Nasoleza, nagobela Kikoona.
"*TataKishaija kya Manono*
Maha oli Muziba.
Ningya kulamya omw' Omukama Wamala."
Ati, "Nakutaishula otaikazaayo magulu."

Kanagiile kwija, nshanga Nyakami Nyamyehoolo.
Ahi, "Nakutaishula otaikazaayo magulu."

NOTES

389 Escort . . . Return . . . Tell him . . . These quoted commands suggest, with great economy, the coercive practices of a multi-tiered state bureaucracy.

394 Without disease [or] consultation fees describe those that suffered a sudden death.

POETIC STANZAS

389-391: names for the other world structured as **aaab** quoted speech/ described action

393-393.3: names for the other world alternately structured as **aabb** and **abba**; Nimwo initial/ omwo initial, and quoted speech/ praise for Wamala, respectively

389-397: a verse passage, it seems, made of three quatrains (389-91, 392-392.3, 394-395.1) and concluded by a couplet of incremental repetition (396-397)

398-398.2: stanza in **abba** presence of distant past/ absence

399-402: quatrain in **abab**; composed semantically: in the second line a greater wonder emerges from that inherent in the first; the second couplet coheres syntactically by all verbs in 3rd pers present continuitive or relative inflection

403-405.2: six lines that cohere as as **abcabc** (or 2 + 1 lines whose constituent elements cohere as abcabc)

406-409: stanza in **abba** cohering as presence/ absence of I saw in distant past; in **aaba** as presence or absence of /bona/ see; as **aaab** syntactally as phrase structure a is b/ subject verb object

410-416: compound stanza 3 + 2 + 2 in **aab**, the first two line groups structured as emerging wonder as in 399-402 above, the final couplet a pair of sentences directly describing wondrous equivalences

Therein is "Escort him here!"
Therein is "Return. We've got him!"
Therein is "Tell him to have him beaten!"
Yai!
Ye ye ye
Where an infant totes the baggage.
Yo-o-o

Therein is "Tell him to have him beaten!"
Therein at the home of Wamara, *Essential-Killer*
At *Reedy-swamps Heave-up-and-down*
At "Escort him here!"

Those who died without disease,
Those barred from paying consultation fees.
At the throne of *Wraps-it-up*– Listen, my friend,
"Don't be afraid in there,
Don't be afraid in there at all."

I went running.
And when I arrived at the forecourt gate,
I looked in at the royal house.
My eyes said, "Look to the upper section of the farm."

I found Balanzi spirits decanting beer.
Others were toting ripe bananas.
Those stripping them from a stalk, my friend, were putting them in a grave.

As I watched, Frog washed his legs.
He stepped one leg into the beer tub.
I saw Chameleon:
When it did not flow
He got into the mash.

I saw the mash was human blood,
I go I see shin bones, the funnels,
Ribs woven together, the sieve.
I saw him press the mash into the brewing vessel of the grave.

Beer seats I also saw there, my kings!
Seats in the vessel–
Human heads.
A man lying on his back–
They grind sorghum on his belly.
Eyes, the sorghum.
A human palm, the upper millstone.

Mununju omwo nimwo 'mwa "Twalashagala!"
Nimwo 'mwa "Galula twatweete"
Nimwo 'mwa "Mugambila muteeza!"
Yai!
Ye ye ye
Niyo enkelemeke etweka ebitwaalo.
Yo-o-o

Nimwo 'mwa "Mugambila muteeza!"
Nimwo 'mwa Wamala *Lwanyakwisa*
Omwa Mbimbili itengatenga
Omwa "Twalashagala!"

Abafa batalwaile.
Abatanagila mikimba.
Omwa kituuti ekya *Nyamuzinga* - Hulila baba,
"Otatiinamu,
Otatiinamukwo."

Nkagenda ninyiluka.
Kanagobile mwonene omu biti by' amalembo
Nkaleba nyaluju.
Amaisho gahi, "Leba aha kibanga kya bunyalugulu."

Nshanga bayalula amaalwa abalanzi.
Abanunju mbashomba ebihise.
Abalikuhogola, baba, mbateka omu nyanga.

Kanagiile kuleba, yanaba amagulu Kikele.
Akalibasa kugulu kumoi omu bwaato.
Mbona Mbalaaluju,
Tigwajwile
Yataha omulamba.

Nkabona omulamba gwaba bwamba bw' abantu.
Ngenda mbona milundi niyo mitizo.
Embaju z' omuntu baisibilile nibwo bugwi bw' amaalwa
Nkabona buli aha bwaato obw' enyanga nekamula omulamba.

Ebitebe bya amaalwa nshanga niho, bakama bange!
Ebitebe by' omu bwaato,
Mitwe y'abantu.
Ayabaile agalamile:
Mbamuseelah' omugusha aha lubunda.
Amaisho nigwo mugusha.
Ekiganja niyo nseiso.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 419.1-40.4:
Kajango's wife meets the high god Wamara, who questions her and gives her a task to perform (lines 419.1-430). She bravely does as bidden (lines 431-37) and answers further questions.

NOTES

431 Father-creator is used here as an exclamation in a one-line aside.

433 Coffee berries are often presented to guests in a small saucer-shaped basket.

435 Mortal hosts often provide guests a small napkin of papyrus strands to dust off their hands in preparation for eating coffee berries.

POETIC STANZAS

419.1-420.3: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 1, in **aab** coherent as description/ dialogue; the couplets cohere in parallelism as verb in 1st pers near past + noun; and begin + to greet + as men/ stop + to greet + as woman

421-423: stanza in **aba** by parallelism: he swore + praisename/ he swore truly

423-423.3: threelines that cohere as **abb** by parallelism

424-427.1: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 2 + 2, in **abba**; **a**'s are composed as address + question + address and address + answer; each of the couplets designated as **b** coheres by lexical repetition, of ibwa and ita, respectively and by parallelism

428-430: stanza in **aab** by semantics acts of exchange, by syntax 2nd person subjunctive/ 1st person subjunctive

431-432.1: stanza in **aab** adverbial phrase/ main verb + object

433-437: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 2 + 1, **aaab**; **a**'s are couplets composed as common object + they [convey] to me/ bodypart + of + person(s); finalizing line is three verb; note within **a**'s is a **aab** structure, the constituent parts of first line of couplet are reversed in the final one

Weyei yei
Weyei
Just as they told me, I did not fear.

I came to the palace.
I folded my raffia skirt.
I started greeting like a man.
I stopped greeting like a woman.
"Shumaalamu, Father of men, Wamara"

He swore, *Reedy-marsh Heaves-up-and-down*,
He truly swore.
He swore, *the Enanga*,

He said, "Since I've lived in the spirit world,
I have never been saluted by a living being
Nor have I been saluted by a woman dressed in raffia.

Where are you from, woman?
You, who come to *Where-no-one-goes*, *to Where-iron-needles-are-worn*.
Begin, report. What's been stolen?
Can you not bewail what's been stolen?
Are you bereaved of a lover?
Or are you bereaved of a husband?"
I said, "Father Provider,
You understand as though already told."

"Ascend to my royal house.
Go and bring me coffee berries.
I will return your husband's soul to you."

That day, Father-Creator.
When I ascended to his royal house,
They handed me the coffee berries.

The saucer they handed me was a human ear.
The coffee berries were human eyes.
They placed a napkin in my hand:
My lord, it was a human palm!
I did not refuse. I swallowed hard. I brought the things.

Weyei yei
Weyei
Okwo bangambile, tinabitiinile.

Naija nyaluju.
Nateela ekishenshe.
Nabanza kulamya nk' abashaija.
Nalekela kulamya nk' abakazi.
Nti, "Shumaalamu Ishe abashaija Wamala."

Yayenaila *Mbibili Itengatenga*,
Yayenailakwo.
Yayenaila *Lw' enanga*

Ahi, "Kuluga ntuula omu imala
Tinkalamibwaga muntu ali kulola.
Mala tinkalamibwaga mukazi ajwete ebishenshe.

Iwe mukazi waluga nkahai?
Ayaija *Butagibwa*, *Bwambala-nkinzo*.

Banza ombaluulile okaibwaki?
Okaibwa eky' otatake
Okaita mugenda waawe
Angili okaita omushaija?"
Nti, "Tata Lugaba,
Wabimanyiileyo nka abigambilwe."

"Otembe nyaluju.
Ogye ondetel' emwani.
Nyije nkugalulil' omwooyo gw'omushaija waawe."

Kil' ekyo Ishowanga.
Kanatembile nyaluju,
Bampa emwani.

Olugali bampa, okutwi kw' omuntu.
Emwani banteelaho, amaisho g' abantu.
Bampa ekikalaba omu byala,
Waitu nikyo kiganja ky' omuntu.
Tinayangile, nabileta, namiliza.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 441-59:
Wamara declares that her husband will recover and gives her instructions about what will cure him (lines 441-59). At home Kajango begins to show signs of life as his sisters celebrate in song.

Lines 468-77.2:
The wife sets out from Wamara's palace and travels toward home, gathering substances as Wamara advised her.

NOTES

438.1 Wembaga kinehe is said to be a greeting in the language of the Sukuma people, who live to the south of Hayaland.

462 Sneezing and farting are signs of life.

463 These lines are quoted from a women's wedding song.

POETIC STANZAS

438-441.1: compound stanza sturctured as **aba** by turns of conversation: Wamala/ wife; finalized by repeated couplet;440.1-.4 two couplets structured as **abab** semantically statement of place/ present spiritual condition of wife; first two couplets cohere semantically

442-444: stanza in **aab**, finalized in a line that repeats the principal verb and contains the marker "this day"

445-459: compound stanza in **aaaaab**, composed of couplets that are three times out of five expanded to 3 or 4 lines; they cohere by parallelism: double verb + noun + noun (praisename)/ May your husband double verb (verb derived from noun in first line); the final couplet shares none of this structure but transforms the noun into verb figure by making the noun initial in the first line (as opposed to (near) final in the **a**'s) and the verb derived from it final in the second line; couplets are expanded by adding an additional line type (line 445) an additional line of praise (452) or two additional lines of praise with parallel syntax (449-449.1)

466-467.1: quoted song in **aab** pattern

When I had brought these things before him,
He said, "You, woman, *wembaga kinehe*?
Where are you from?"
I said, "*Where-iron-needles-are-worn*.
I come from Buyonya,
I've come to search.
Spirits travel here,
They have followed me."
He said, "Your husband will not die.
He's eaten nothing of another.

Let me show the way to you, woman.
I'll wash away your journey's dust.
I'll make you stout, for today you've lost your stoutness.

Go to the shoreline of the Bull's Lake.
Go get what the lake has vomited up–
So your husband will be vomited up by the Balanzi spirits.
Go cut *Falls-and-rises*–
That is, *Sharpened-points*,
That is, raffia palm–
So your husband will arise from the Balanzi spirits.
Go cut papyrus–
The one they call *Lanky boy child*–
May your husband . . .
Go, find the water-lily *Never-swallowed*,
So your husband will revive and leave the Balanzi.
Cut him a staff of conqueror wood (*musinga*).
So your husband will conquer (*singa*) the spirits.
Your seed-bull I return to you."
He said, "When he grows up, you can plant his seeds."

While I was there, where he spoke to me,
At home, the ones with Kajango heard . . .
He sneezed!
He begin to fart!

His sisters there began to sang,
"'Uncover, let me look.
Uncover, let me look.
Uncover, let me look.
Uncover, let me look.
All good the things are not yet in view.'"

I took the road
I was brought by the road.
I left there in a hurry . . .

Kanabimuleteile omu maisho,
Ati, "Iwe mukazi *wembagakinehe*
Waluga nkahai?"
Nti, "*Bwambala-nkinzo*.
Naluga Buyonya,
Nyizile kubyonya.
Bigenda kununju,
Ebizimu byampondeile."
Ahi, "Kahi omushaija waawe taafe.
Takalyaaga ka muntu.

Kankulagiilila iwe mukazi.
Nkwogye enzilo ez' otuula nogenda.
Nkugomole kil' eki otagomokile.

Ogye olabe omumwalo gw' Enyanja lwa *Ngundu*
Ogye oihyeyo entanaki y' enyanja -
Balo agye atanakwe abalanzi.
Ogye oteme *Olugwandwimuka* -
Nilwo *Lushongolwa*,
Nilwo lukindo -
Balo agende aimuke omu Balanzi.
Ogye oteme olufunjo -
Ndwo balikweeta *BojoMukenwa-ngingo* -
Balo agende akenwe omugilo
Ogye ohige ilebe, *Entamilwa*,
Balo agye ahibuke aluge omu Balanzi.
Okunde omutemele omuguma gw' omusinga.
Balo agye asinge abalanzi.
Embiikile yawe nagikuha."
Ati, "Olwo elikula oligenda ogibikulule."

Kanabaile mbali yagambila ekyo,
Ababaile bainabo...
Yayesaimula!
Yabanza okunyampa!

Ababaile bali aho banyanya,
"' Nshulula, ndebe.
Nshulula, ndebe.
Nshulula ndebe.
Nshulula ndebe.
Ebilungi tibibonwa byoona.'"

Nakwata omuhanda
Naletwa omuhanda...
Nalugamu nyilukile

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 478-522.1:
Kajango and his wife meet (lines 478-83), argue about the events that occurred (lines 484-518.1), and are reconciled.

NOTES

469.1 The host was a teetotaler, a religious man, and feared, I think, the negative effect of beer on the poet's art.

479 This seems to be a false start.

481 The identity of the first-person narrative voice has shifted to Kajango.

POETIC STANZAS

470-473: complex stanza in **abac**: **a**'s are couplets formed by incremental repetition (470-471 and 471.3-472); **b**'s are 2 similarly constructed but singular lines (471.1-471.2); **c** is related to one of the **b**'s by repetition

475-477.2: stanza in **abbac**: **a**'s are related by repetition; **b**'s are the list of healing items embedded in a variety of syntactic structures; **c** is the repetition of a familiar line, and like the **c** in the complex stanza directly above

487-489: stanza in **aab** by syntax one/ two fully inflected verbs, by semantics, action and response

490-492: stanza in **aab** by lexicon

Stop for tape change

[Singer: Find me a little something to drink. --
Host: Go on, Sir, go on]

I came to the lake by that road.
I took from the lake its vomit.
I cut a staff of *conqueror* wood.
I ran and searched for *Falls-and-rises*.
I searched for water-lily, *Never-swallowed*.
I brought the water-lily, *Never-swallowed*
A staff of *conqueror* wood...

When I made sure I had them all,
My lord, Provider,

I met him then in the forecourt.
I came with a staff of *conqueror* wood
And water-lily, *Never-swallowed*,
Falls-and-rises, *Sharpened-points*,
And lake sand, which is the lake's vomit.
He met me there.
The raffia skirt had left its mark.

A wife was forgotton,
And a husband, almost forgotten.
[Then she began to ask me, "Child, my kings–"]
My lord, eyes never forget someone you've seen.

When I saw her I said, "My wife, my friend,
Why pass me by?
Don't I look like the man who married you?"
She said, "You do look like the one who married me, my husband."
"Where were you?"
She said, "When I found out you died,
I went to Wamara's to find your soul."
"You speak wrongly, my wife.

When I left Buzinja of Nshanshame, we were together.
I brought back horns of the rhino, *Shrill-cry*.
I added in the tail, but you did not relent.

You'd abused me.
You'd abused me.
You'd begun, 'Child, you bring no wealth.'

Stop for tape change

[Ohigule oije oshube ompe nyweho--
Iloko waitu iloko]

Naletwa omuhanda gw'enyanja.
Naiyayo entanaki y'enyanja
Natema omuguma gw' omusinga
Nailuka nahiga *Olugwanilwimuka*
Nahiga ilebe *Entamilwa*.
Naleta ilebe *Entamilwa*
Omuguma gw' omusinga

Olwo nagenzile mbyekomize,
Waitu Lugaba,

Nkamubuganganwa omu ilembo
Nagobile n' omuguma gw' omusinga
N' eilebe *Entamilwa*,
Olugwanilwimuka, *Lushongolwa*,
Omushenye gw'enyanja niyo ntanaki y'enyanja.
Akambuganganwa.
Ekishenshe kilanyoile.

Omukazi akaanyeba,
N' omushaija yalenga kweba.
Kyonka akambaza "Bojo, bakama bange,
Waitu amaisho tigebwa owo waboine."

Kanamuboine nti, "Mukazi wange, baba,
Nka walabaho?
Ninshana alakushweile."
Ahi, "Na inye nonshana oti olanshweile mushaija wange."

"Otuula nkaha?"
Ati, "Olwo nasigile wafa,
Ngenda omwa Wamala kukuhigila omwooyo."
"Nobeiya mukazi wange."

Nkaluga Buzinja bwa Nshanshame, tuli amoi.
Natunda amahembe g' enkula *Lwakifooto*.
Ntekaho ekyoshe otakahumwile.

Okanjuma.
Okanjuma.
Okabanza olwa mbele oti, 'Bojo totunda.'

NOTES

506.1 Laughter in the nose is a sardonic gesture.

POETIC STANZAS

493-495: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 1, couplets defined by syntax (493-93.1, second person), lexical repetition 94-94.1.

496-499.1: three couplets that each cohere by parallelism and repetition, repetition, and parallelism, respectively

500-502: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 1, number sequence, noun and praisename, praisename alone, in a sense based on phrasing 2 2 1.

503-509: mirror stanzas with one line kicker; two couplets + two couplets + added line; initial couplet in each stanza composed of adverbial past Perfect in second Person + near past second person; second couplet coheres semantically; the first couplet of the second stanza incrementally repeats and transforms the second couplet of the first stanza

You'd gone to fetch water.
  You used the traders for my abuse.
You said, 'They'd carried so many things they were throwing some away.'
  I said, 'If they were throwing some away, my wife,
Why didn't you bring me just a few so I might see them too?'

You said, 'You're worth less than the beer jug at our house, *Half-full*.'
You said, 'You're worth less than the dove, the *Trilling-voice*.' My kings!
I said nothing . . .
  I said, 'Set beer bananas to ferment.
Leave off! I'll travel in trade.
  I'll go. I'll bring the things, my wife.'

I spent one day there.
  On the second I returned.
A rhinoceros I killed, the *Shrill-cry*, the *Foot-fall*,
His eye, a small hole in a dark ceiling.

When you came to welcome me,
  You welcomed me with open arms.
Into the forecourt you came, showing molars on both sides.
The laughter you were laughing was like that of weaver-birds.

But when you left the hearth,
  You showed me only laughter in the nose.
'Cattle horns?' you said, 'They're in Kihanja.
What now, my husband? Do you bring them from Buzinja?'
Anger gripped me, and your plantains I did not eat.

I went to Ankole Katoke, and I traded for heavy bullocks.
I added milking cows.
  I brought red bulls.
'A bull I'll choose,' I thought.
  'I'll butcher it for her,
  And she'll take from it a tasty bit of meat.'
I brought goats.
  I added sheepskins.

Okaba ogenzile omu maizi.
  Wanjumisa abatunzi.
Ohi, 'Batwete mbanaga.'

  Nti, 'Olwo batwete mbanaga, mukazi wange,
Kutaba wandetelaho bike bike nkaleba?'

Ohi, 'Nokilwa ekimuga eky' omwaitu *Bwishegati*'

Ohi, 'Nokilwa akaiba *Lukongota*.' Bakama bange!

Tinakugambile.
  Nagamba, 'Nyalikila enkundi.
Oleke ntunde
  Ngye mbilete, mukazi wange.'

Nkamalayo ekilo kimoi.
  Ekya kabili naihulula.
Enkula nkagiita, *Lwakifooto z'ebilindigita*
Akaisho kayo kahengezi k'enju.

Kowamazile kuntula,
  Wantula wantegela.
Omu kibuga okaija nonyatulila lino eli n' eli.

Ensheko okaba nonshekela ey' ebishanda.

Kowagiile kuluga enjulugulu
  Wanyatulila ey' omunyindo.
Oti, 'Amahembe g' ente wagasiga Kihanja.
Mbwenu mushaija wange, otuula kugatunda Buzinja?'

Enaabi yankwata, n'ebitoke ndwo ntabilile.

Ntuula Nkole Katooke natunda eshamaitu.
Nataho ezaile.
  Natekaho engaju.
'Enumi kandeba,
  Tuli hamo mutemele,
  Alyeho akanyama.'
Natekaho embuzi.
  Ngutaileho oluhu lw'entaama.

NOTES
517 White and Big-spot are names for cattle based on their markings.

Now, that's how I brought the wealth, child,
That's how you don't love me. You only crave my wealth, my kings.
That's how I fainted and lost consciousness.

Tell me of the White and the Big-spot,
The ones from which you got a tasty bit of meat,
Or of the White and the Big-spot,
The ones from which you drank rich milk.

Now, my kings,
I forgive you.
I forgive you, my wife.
Return inside.

Women are betrayers.
They make trouble in ways you cannot (foresee)

Mbwenu olwo nasigile naleta eitunga bojo,
Olwo otenda 'nye, ogonz' eitunga lyange, bakama bange.

Olwo nagenzile nkakaba. Ntamanyiile.

Ongambile Kisa na Ibamba,
Eyo wahileho akanyama,
Angili Kisa na Ibamba,
Eyo wanyweleho omuhondo.

Mbwenu bakama bange,
Nkugalulile.
Nkugalulile, mukazi wange.
Oshube omu nju.

Abakazi mbanzi
Bakutelela ekyotali(kumanya).